

Demographic Data Missing Value Handling (With Constraint)

BRSM Project

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Contents

1	PART I: DEMOGRAPHIC DATA PIPELINE	4
1.1	1. Constraint Definition	4
1.2	2. Load Data	4
1.3	3. Remove Invalid Rows (Critical Step)	5
1.4	3.1 Condition Synchronization and Correction (Filename Ground Truth)	5
1.5	4. Inspect Missing Values (Before Imputation)	7
1.6	5. Define Mode Function	7
1.7	6. Compute Replacement Values	7
1.8	7. Apply Imputation (Only Valid Rows)	7
1.9	8. Verification	8
1.10	9. Save Clean Data	8
1.11	10. Summary	8
1.12	10B. Participant Demographics Summary (Demographic data.xlsx)	9
1.13	10A. Data Preprocessing Report	12
2	PART II: BEHAVIORAL DATA PREPROCESSING & EXCLUSIONS	14
2.1	11. Fill Participant CSV Files by Matching Sub ID	14
2.2	12. Exclusion Criterion	15
2.3	13. Post-Exclusion Data Present in BRSM Data CSV	18
3	PART III: RESULTS & STATISTICAL ANALYSIS	20
3.1	14. Corrected Participant Demographics Summary (Final)	20
3.2	15. Descriptive Statistics (Updated From Current Data)	23
3.2.1	15.1 Overall Accuracy by Condition	23
3.2.2	15.2 Accuracy by Condition and Frame Type	24
3.2.3	15.3 Reaction Time and Confidence by Condition	24
3.3	16. Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)	24

3.3.1	16.1 Distribution of Accuracy (Figures 1A & 1B)	25
3.3.2	16.2 Comparison by Condition (Figure 2)	26
3.3.3	16.3 Comparison by Frame Type (Figure 3A)	27
3.3.4	16.4 Interaction Heatmap (Figure 3B)	28
3.3.5	16.5 Consistency and Variability	29
3.3.6	16.6 Interaction Performance with 95% CI (Figure 4)	29
3.3.7	16.7 Age Distribution and Balance (Figures 5A & 5B)	31
3.3.8	16.8 Gender Breakdown and Composition (Figures 5C & 5D)	32
3.4	18. Hypothesis Testing: Accuracy (NB vs AB)	34
3.4.1	18.1 ART ANOVA (Condition Main Effect)	34
3.4.2	18.2 Mann–Whitney U Test	35
3.4.3	18.3 Permutation Test	36
3.4.4	18.4 Median Test (Mood’s)	36
3.4.5	18.5 Summary of Findings	37
3.4.6	18.6 Conclusion	38
3.5	19. H2 — Boundary Advantage	38
3.5.1	Hypothesis	38
3.5.2	Methodology	38
3.5.3	19.1 ART ANOVA (FrameType Effect)	39
3.5.4	19.2 Wilcoxon Signed-Rank Test	39
3.5.5	19.3 Sign Test	40
3.5.6	19.4 Friedman Test	41
3.5.7	19.5 Summary of Findings (H2)	41
3.5.8	Conclusion (H2)	42
3.6	20. H3 — Event-Middle Stability	42
3.6.1	Hypothesis	42
3.6.2	Methodology	43
3.6.3	20.1 ART ANOVA (Simple Effect on EM)	43
3.6.4	20.2 Mann–Whitney U Test	43
3.6.5	20.3 Permutation Test	44
3.6.6	20.4 Bootstrap Comparison	45
3.6.7	20.5 Expected Result	45
3.6.8	20.6 Summary of Findings (H3)	45
3.6.9	Conclusion (H3)	46
3.7	21. H4 — Interaction Effect (MOST IMPORTANT)	47
3.7.1	Hypothesis	47

3.7.2	Methodology	47
3.7.3	21.1 ART ANOVA (Interaction Effect)	47
3.7.4	21.2 Difference Score + Mann–Whitney Test	48
3.7.5	21.3 Permutation Interaction Test	49
3.7.6	21.4 Friedman Test (Robustness Check)	49
3.7.7	21.5 Expected Result	50
3.7.8	21.6 Summary of Findings (H4)	50
3.7.9	Conclusion (H4)	50
3.8	22. H5 — Confidence–Accuracy Relationship	51
3.8.1	Hypothesis	51
3.8.2	Methodology	51
3.8.3	22.1 Spearman Correlation	51
3.8.4	22.2 Mann–Whitney U Test (Confidence)	52
3.8.5	22.3 Interaction Regression	53
3.8.6	22.4 Permutation Correlation Test	53
3.8.7	Expected Result	54
3.8.8	22.5 Summary of Findings (H5)	54
3.9	23. H6 — Difficulty Moderation	54
3.9.1	Hypothesis	54
3.9.2	Methodology	55
3.9.3	23.1 Kruskal–Wallis Test	55
3.9.4	23.2 ART ANOVA (Extended Interaction)	56
3.9.5	23.3 Pairwise Mann–Whitney U Test	56
3.9.6	23.4 Permutation Test	57
3.9.7	Expected Result	57
3.9.8	23.5 Summary of Findings (H6)	57
3.9.9	Conclusion (H6)	58
3.10	24. H7 — Variability Effect	58
3.10.1	Hypothesis	58
3.10.2	Methodology	58
3.10.3	24.1 Levene’s Test	58
3.10.4	24.2 Brown–Forsythe Test	59
3.10.5	24.3 SD Comparison + Permutation	59
3.10.6	24.4 Bootstrapped Variance Comparison	60
3.10.7	Expected Result	61
3.10.8	24.5 Summary of Findings (H7)	61

3.10.9 Conclusion (H7)	61
3.11 25. H8 — Encoding Strength Effect	61
3.11.1 Hypothesis	61
3.11.2 Methodology	61
3.11.3 25.1 Spearman Correlation	62
3.11.4 25.2 Linear Regression	62
3.11.5 25.3 Median Split + Mann–Whitney Test	63
3.11.6 25.4 Permutation Test	64
3.11.7 Expected Result	65
3.11.8 25.5 Summary of Findings (H8)	65
3.11.9 Conclusion (H8)	65
3.12 26. Final Results Summary	65

1 PART I: DEMOGRAPHIC DATA PIPELINE

1.1 1. Constraint Definition

Missing values in the demographic dataset are filled only for valid participant entries.

Rules:

- A row is valid only if participant_id (subId) is present.
- Rows where participant_id is missing or empty are removed before imputation.

For data safety, this analysis uses the copy file:

- Demographic data.xlsx (Local project file)

1.2 2. Load Data

```
library(tidyverse)
library(readxl)
library(writexl)
library(scales)

input_file <- "Demographic data.xlsx"

if (str_detect(str_to_lower(input_file), "\\..csv$")) {
  demo_data_raw <- read_csv(input_file, show_col_types = FALSE)
} else if (str_detect(str_to_lower(input_file), "\\..xlsx$")) {
  demo_data_raw <- read_excel(input_file)
} else {
  stop("Unsupported input format. Use .csv or .xlsx")
}

cat("Rows loaded:", nrow(demo_data_raw), "\n")
```

```
## Rows loaded: 185
```

```
cat("Columns loaded:", ncol(demo_data_raw), "\n")
```

```
## Columns loaded: 7
```

```
print(names(demo_data_raw))
```

```
## [1] "Sub ID"      "Age"          "Gender"        "Handedness"
## [5] "Vision"      "participant_id" "Condition"
```

1.3 3. Remove Invalid Rows (Critical Step)

```
# Build participant_id if not already present.
# If participant_id already exists, keep it.
if (!"participant_id" %in% names(demo_data_raw)) {
  demo_data <- demo_data_raw %>%
    mutate(participant_id = str_to_lower(str_extract(`Sub ID`, "(?i)sub\\d+")))
} else {
  demo_data <- demo_data_raw %>%
    mutate(participant_id = str_to_lower(participant_id))
}
```

```
rows_before_filter <- nrow(demo_data)
```

```
demo_data <- demo_data %>%
  filter(!is.na(participant_id) & participant_id != "")
```

```
rows_after_filter <- nrow(demo_data)
```

```
cat("Rows before participant_id filter:", rows_before_filter, "\n")
```

```
## Rows before participant_id filter: 185
```

```
cat("Rows after participant_id filter:", rows_after_filter, "\n")
```

```
## Rows after participant_id filter: 185
```

```
cat("Rows removed due to invalid participant_id:", rows_before_filter - rows_after_filter, "\n")
```

```
## Rows removed due to invalid participant_id: 0
```

1.4 3.1 Condition Synchronization and Correction (Filename Ground Truth)

```

# Get paths for CSV files
participant_data_dir_sync <- if (dir.exists(file.path("BRSM data csv", "BRSM data csv"))) {
  file.path("BRSM data csv", "BRSM data csv")
} else {
  "BRSM data csv"
}
sync_files <- list.files(participant_data_dir_sync, pattern = "\\..csv$", full.names = TRUE)

# Create a lookup for conditions from filenames (Ground Truth)
filename_sync_lookup <- tibble(filepath = sync_files) %>%
  mutate(
    participant_id = str_to_lower(str_extract(basename(filepath), "(?i)sub\\d+")),
    # Extract AB or NB from filename
    filename_cond = str_to_upper(str_trim(str_extract(basename(filepath), "(?i)(?<=_) (AB|NB)\\s*(?=_)")),
  ) %>%
  filter(!is.na(participant_id), !is.na(filename_cond)) %>%
  distinct(participant_id, .keep_all = TRUE)

# Extract conditions recorded in Excel (Sub ID column)
demo_data <- demo_data %>%
  mutate(
    excel_cond = str_to_upper(str_trim(str_extract(`Sub ID`, "(?i)_(AB|NB)\\b"))) %>% str_remove("^_")
  )

# Join and detect mismatches
demo_data <- demo_data %>%
  left_join(filename_sync_lookup %>% select(participant_id, filename_cond), by = "participant_id")

# Log corrections explicitly
mismatches <- demo_data %>%
  filter(!is.na(filename_cond), !is.na(excel_cond), filename_cond != excel_cond)

if (nrow(mismatches) > 0) {
  cat("\n--- CONDITION CORRECTIONS (Based on Filenames) ---\n")
  for (i in 1:nrow(mismatches)) {
    cat(sprintf("Updated %s: Excel (%s) -> Filename (%s)\n",
                mismatches$participant_id[i], mismatches$excel_cond[i], mismatches$filename_cond[i]))
  }
  cat("-----\n")
}

##
## --- CONDITION CORRECTIONS (Based on Filenames) ---
## Updated sub87: Excel (AB) -> Filename (NB)
## Updated sub157: Excel (NB) -> Filename (AB)
## Updated sub86: Excel (AB) -> Filename (NB)
## -----

# Apply Ground Truth: Use Filename cond if available, otherwise fallback to Excel
demo_data <- demo_data %>%
  mutate(
    Condition = ifelse(!is.na(filename_cond), filename_cond, excel_cond)
  ) %>%

```

```
select(-filename_cond, -excel_cond)
```

1.5 4. Inspect Missing Values (Before Imputation)

```
colSums(is.na(demo_data))
```

```
##          Sub ID          Age          Gender          Handedness          Vision
##           0           0           0           0           0
## participant_id      Condition
##           0           0
```

1.6 5. Define Mode Function

```
get_mode <- function(x) {
  x <- x[!is.na(x) & trimws(as.character(x)) != ""]
  ux <- unique(x)
  ux[which.max(tabulate(match(x, ux)))]
}
```

1.7 6. Compute Replacement Values

```
age_median <- median(as.numeric(demo_data$Age), na.rm = TRUE)

gender_mode <- get_mode(demo_data$Gender)
hand_mode   <- get_mode(demo_data$Handedness)
vision_mode <- get_mode(demo_data$Vision)

cat("Age median:", age_median, "\n")
```

```
## Age median: 22
```

```
cat("Gender mode:", gender_mode, "\n")
```

```
## Gender mode: Male
```

```
cat("Handedness mode:", hand_mode, "\n")
```

```
## Handedness mode: Right handed
```

```
cat("Vision mode:", vision_mode, "\n")
```

```
## Vision mode: Normal
```

1.8 7. Apply Imputation (Only Valid Rows)

```
demo_clean <- demo_data %>%
  mutate(
    Age = as.numeric(Age),
    Age = ifelse(is.na(Age), age_median, Age),
    Gender = ifelse(is.na(Gender) | trimws(Gender) == "", gender_mode, Gender),
    Handedness = ifelse(is.na(Handedness) | trimws(Handedness) == "", hand_mode, Handedness),
    Vision = ifelse(is.na(Vision) | trimws(Vision) == "", vision_mode, Vision)
  )
```

1.9 8. Verification

```
colSums(is.na(demo_clean))
```

```
##          Sub ID          Age          Gender          Handedness          Vision
##              0              0              0              0              0
## participant_id    Condition
##              0              0
```

Expected result: no missing values in Age, Gender, Handedness, Vision for valid participant rows.

1.10 9. Save Clean Data

```
if (str_detect(str_to_lower(input_file), "\\..csv$")) {
  write_csv(demo_clean, input_file)
} else if (str_detect(str_to_lower(input_file), "\\..xlsx$")) {
  write_xlsx(demo_clean, input_file)
} else {
  stop("Unsupported input format. Use .csv or .xlsx")
}

cat("Updated file in place:", input_file, "\n")
```

```
## Updated file in place: Demographic data.xlsx
```

1.11 10. Summary

```
summary_tbl <- tibble(
  Metric = c(
    "Rows loaded",
    "Rows after participant_id validation",
    "Rows removed for missing/empty participant_id",
    "Missing Age after imputation",
    "Missing Gender after imputation",
    "Missing Handedness after imputation",
    "Missing Vision after imputation"
  )
)
```



```

),
Value = c(
  rows_before_filter,
  rows_after_filter,
  rows_before_filter - rows_after_filter,
  sum(is.na(demo_clean$Age)),
  sum(is.na(demo_clean$Gender) | trimws(demo_clean$Gender) == ""),
  sum(is.na(demo_clean$Handedness) | trimws(demo_clean$Handedness) == ""),
  sum(is.na(demo_clean$Vision) | trimws(demo_clean$Vision) == "")
)
)

summary_tbl

```

```

## # A tibble: 7 x 2
##   Metric                                Value
##   <chr>                                <int>
## 1 Rows loaded                          185
## 2 Rows after participant_id validation  185
## 3 Rows removed for missing/empty participant_id    0
## 4 Missing Age after imputation            0
## 5 Missing Gender after imputation          0
## 6 Missing Handedness after imputation       0
## 7 Missing Vision after imputation          0

```

1.12 10B. Participant Demographics Summary (Demographic data.xlsx)

```

# Build a clean demographic summary table similar to the report style shown.

id_source <- if ("Sub ID" %in% names(demo_data_raw)) {
  as.character(demo_data_raw$`Sub ID`)
} else if ("participant_id" %in% names(demo_data_raw)) {
  as.character(demo_data_raw$participant_id)
} else {
  rep(NA_character_, nrow(demo_data_raw))
}

demo_for_summary <- demo_data_raw %>%
  select(-any_of("Condition")) %>%
  mutate(
    id_source = id_source,
    participant_id = str_to_lower(str_extract(id_source, "(?i)sub\\d+")),
    Age_num = suppressWarnings(as.numeric(Age)),
    Gender_chr = as.character(Gender),
    Handedness_chr = as.character(Handedness),
    Vision_chr = as.character(Vision)
  ) %>%
  left_join(demo_data %>% select(participant_id, Condition), by = "participant_id") %>%
  filter(!is.na(participant_id), participant_id != "")

demo_complete <- demo_for_summary %>%

```

```

filter(
  !is.na(Age_num),
  !is.na(Gender_chr) & trimws(Gender_chr) != "",
  !is.na(Handedness_chr) & trimws(Handedness_chr) != "",
  !is.na(Vision_chr) & trimws(Vision_chr) != ""
) %>%
mutate(
  Gender_std = case_when(
    str_squish(str_to_lower(Gender_chr)) %in% c("female", "f") ~ "female",
    str_squish(str_to_lower(Gender_chr)) %in% c("male", "m") ~ "male",
    str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Gender_chr)), "^female\\b") ~ "female",
    str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Gender_chr)), "^male\\b") ~ "male",
    TRUE ~ "other"
  ),
  Handedness_std = case_when(
    str_squish(str_to_lower(Handedness_chr)) %in% c("right", "r", "right-handed", "right handed") ~ "right",
    str_squish(str_to_lower(Handedness_chr)) %in% c("left", "l", "left-handed", "left handed") ~ "left",
    str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Handedness_chr)), "^right") ~ "right",
    str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Handedness_chr)), "^left") ~ "left",
    TRUE ~ "other"
  ),
  Vision_std = case_when(
    str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Vision_chr)), "uncorrected") ~ "uncorrected",
    str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Vision_chr)), "corrected") ~ "corrected",
    str_squish(str_to_lower(Vision_chr)) %in% c("normal", "normal vision") ~ "normal",
    str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Vision_chr)), "normal") ~ "normal",
    TRUE ~ "other"
  )
)

demo_summary_tbl <- tibble(
  Characteristic = c(
    "N (complete demographic records)",
    "Age - Mean (SD)",
    "Age - Range",
    "Female",
    "Male",
    "Right-handed",
    "Left-handed",
    "Normal vision",
    "Corrected to normal",
    "Uncorrected vision difficulty"
  ),
  Value = c(
    nrow(demo_complete),
    sprintf("%.1f (%.1f)", mean(demo_complete$Age_num, na.rm = TRUE), sd(demo_complete$Age_num, na.rm = TRUE)),
    sprintf("%d - %d", floor(min(demo_complete$Age_num, na.rm = TRUE)), ceiling(max(demo_complete$Age_num, na.rm = TRUE))),
    sum(demo_complete$Gender_std == "female", na.rm = TRUE),
    sum(demo_complete$Gender_std == "male", na.rm = TRUE),
    sum(demo_complete$Handedness_std == "right", na.rm = TRUE),
    sum(demo_complete$Handedness_std == "left", na.rm = TRUE),
    sum(demo_complete$Vision_std == "normal", na.rm = TRUE),
    sum(demo_complete$Vision_std == "corrected", na.rm = TRUE),

```

```

    sum(demo_complete$Vision_std == "uncorrected", na.rm = TRUE)
  )
)

condition_demo_tbl <- demo_complete %>%
  filter(!is.na(Condition)) %>%
  group_by(Condition) %>%
  summarise(
    N = n(),
    `Age M` = round(mean(Age_num, na.rm = TRUE), 1),
    `Age SD` = round(sd(Age_num, na.rm = TRUE), 1),
    Female = sum(Gender_std == "female", na.rm = TRUE),
    Male = sum(Gender_std == "male", na.rm = TRUE),
    `Right-handed` = sum(Handedness_std == "right", na.rm = TRUE),
    `Left-handed` = sum(Handedness_std == "left", na.rm = TRUE),
    `Normal vision` = sum(Vision_std == "normal", na.rm = TRUE),
    `Corrected to normal` = sum(Vision_std == "corrected", na.rm = TRUE),
    `Uncorrected vision difficulty` = sum(Vision_std == "uncorrected", na.rm = TRUE),
    .groups = "drop"
  )

cat("Participant Demographics Summary\n")

```

```
## Participant Demographics Summary
```

```
cat("-----\n")
```

```
## -----
```

```
cat("Total entries in Demographic data.xlsx:", nrow(demo_for_summary), "\n")
```

```
## Total entries in Demographic data.xlsx: 185
```

```
cat("Complete demographic records used for summary:", nrow(demo_complete), "\n\n")
```

```
## Complete demographic records used for summary: 185
```

```
demo_summary_tbl
```

```
## # A tibble: 10 x 2
##   Characteristic      Value
##   <chr>              <chr>
## 1 N (complete demographic records) 185
## 2 Age - Mean (SD)      22.3 (2.2)
## 3 Age - Range         19 - 34
## 4 Female              50
## 5 Male               135
## 6 Right-handed        176
## 7 Left-handed          9
## 8 Normal vision       106
## 9 Corrected to normal  77
## 10 Uncorrected vision difficulty    2
```

```
condition_demo_tbl
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 x 11
##   Condition      N `Age M` `Age SD` Female  Male `Right-handed` `Left-handed`
##   <chr>      <int>   <dbl>   <dbl> <int> <int>         <int>         <int>
## 1 AB          91    22.3     2.1    27    64           88           3
## 2 NB          94    22.2     2.2    23    71           88           6
## # i 3 more variables: `Normal vision` <int>, `Corrected to normal` <int>,
## #   `Uncorrected vision difficulty` <int>
```

1.13 10A. Data Preprocessing Report

```
participant_data_dir <- if (dir.exists(file.path("BRSM data csv", "BRSM data csv"))) {
  file.path("BRSM data csv", "BRSM data csv")
} else {
  "BRSM data csv"
}
participant_files_snapshot <- list.files(participant_data_dir, pattern = "\\..csv$", full.names = TRUE)
participant_ids_snapshot <- str_to_lower(str_extract(basename(participant_files_snapshot), "(?i)sub\\d+"))
participant_ids_snapshot <- participant_ids_snapshot[!is.na(participant_ids_snapshot)]

demo_ids_snapshot <- demo_clean %>%
  distinct(participant_id) %>%
  pull(participant_id)

matched_ids_snapshot <- intersect(participant_ids_snapshot, demo_ids_snapshot)
csv_not_in_demo_snapshot <- setdiff(participant_ids_snapshot, demo_ids_snapshot)
demo_not_in_csv_snapshot <- setdiff(demo_ids_snapshot, participant_ids_snapshot)

cat("Current Data Processing Snapshot\n")
```

```
## Current Data Processing Snapshot
```

```
cat("-----\n")
```

```
## -----
```

```
cat("Total participant CSV files found:", length(participant_files_snapshot), "\n")
```

```
## Total participant CSV files found: 171
```

```
cat("Unique participant IDs from CSV filenames:", length(unique(participant_ids_snapshot)), "\n")
```

```
## Unique participant IDs from CSV filenames: 171
```

```
cat("Rows in Demographic data.xlsx (before participant_id filter):", rows_before_filter, "\n")
```

```
## Rows in Demographic data.xlsx (before participant_id filter): 185
```

```

cat("Rows in Demographic data.xlsx (after participant_id filter):", rows_after_filter, "\n")

## Rows in Demographic data.xlsx (after participant_id filter): 185

cat("Unique participant IDs in cleaned demographics (Demographic data.xlsx):", length(unique(demo_ids_snapshot)), "\n")

## Unique participant IDs in cleaned demographics (Demographic data.xlsx): 185

cat("Participant IDs matched (CSV <-> demographics):", length(unique(matched_ids_snapshot)), "\n")

## Participant IDs matched (CSV <-> demographics): 171

cat("CSV participant IDs missing in demographics:", length(unique(csv_not_in_demo_snapshot)), "\n")

## CSV participant IDs missing in demographics: 0

cat("Demographic participant IDs missing in CSV:", length(unique(demo_not_in_csv_snapshot)), "\n")

## Demographic participant IDs missing in CSV: 14

if (length(demo_not_in_csv_snapshot) > 0) {
  cat("Example demographic IDs missing in CSV:", paste(head(demo_not_in_csv_snapshot, 10), collapse = " "), "\n")
}

## Example demographic IDs missing in CSV: sub11, sub05, sub06, sub20, sub12, sub03, sub10, sub02, sub11, sub04

preprocessing_report <- tibble(
  Metric = c(
    "Total participant CSV files",
    "Unique participant IDs from CSV filenames",
    "Rows in Demographic data.xlsx before participant_id filter",
    "Rows in Demographic data.xlsx after participant_id filter",
    "Unique participant IDs in cleaned demographics",
    "Matched participant IDs (CSV vs demographics)",
    "CSV participant IDs missing in demographics",
    "Demographic participant IDs missing in CSV"
  ),
  Value = c(
    length(participant_files_snapshot),
    length(unique(participant_ids_snapshot)),
    rows_before_filter,
    rows_after_filter,
    length(unique(demo_ids_snapshot)),
    length(unique(matched_ids_snapshot)),
    length(unique(csv_not_in_demo_snapshot)),
    length(unique(demo_not_in_csv_snapshot))
  )
)

preprocessing_report

```

```
## # A tibble: 8 x 2
##   Metric                                Value
##   <chr>                                <int>
## 1 Total participant CSV files          171
## 2 Unique participant IDs from CSV filenames 171
## 3 Rows in Demographic data.xlsx before participant_id filter 185
## 4 Rows in Demographic data.xlsx after participant_id filter 185
## 5 Unique participant IDs in cleaned demographics 185
## 6 Matched participant IDs (CSV vs demographics) 171
## 7 CSV participant IDs missing in demographics 0
## 8 Demographic participant IDs missing in CSV 14
```

2 PART II: BEHAVIORAL DATA PREPROCESSING & EXCLUSIONS

2.1 11. Fill Participant CSV Files by Matching Sub ID

```
# Folder containing one CSV per participant
participant_data_dir <- if (dir.exists(file.path("BRSM data csv", "BRSM data csv"))) {
  file.path("BRSM data csv", "BRSM data csv")
} else {
  "BRSM data csv"
}
participant_files <- list.files(participant_data_dir, pattern = "\\..csv$", full.names = TRUE)

# Keep one cleaned demographic row per participant_id
demo_lookup <- demo_clean %>%
  distinct(participant_id, .keep_all = TRUE) %>%
  transmute(
    participant_id,
    age_ref = Age,
    gender_ref = Gender,
    handedness_ref = Handedness,
    vision_ref = Vision
  )

updated_files <- 0
matched_files <- 0
unmatched_files <- 0

for (f in participant_files) {
  # Match sub id from filename (example: sub17, sub150)
  subid <- str_to_lower(str_extract(basename(f), "(?i)sub\\d+"))

  if (is.na(subid) || !(subid %in% demo_lookup$participant_id)) {
    unmatched_files <- unmatched_files + 1
    next
  }

  ref <- demo_lookup %>% filter(participant_id == subid) %>% slice(1)
```

```

dat <- read_csv(f, col_types = cols(.default = col_character()), show_col_types = FALSE)

# Directly write demographic columns for this participant.
# Other columns are left unchanged.
if ("age" %in% names(dat)) {
  dat$age <- as.character(ref$age_ref)
}
if ("gender" %in% names(dat)) {
  dat$gender <- as.character(ref$gender_ref)
}
if ("handedness" %in% names(dat)) {
  dat$handedness <- as.character(ref$handedness_ref)
}
if ("vision" %in% names(dat)) {
  dat$vision <- as.character(ref$vision_ref)
}

write_csv(dat, f, na = "")
matched_files <- matched_files + 1
updated_files <- updated_files + 1
}

csv_fill_summary <- tibble(
  Metric = c(
    "Total participant CSV files found",
    "Files with matched sub ID in demographics",
    "Files updated in place",
    "Files without demographic sub ID match"
  ),
  Value = c(
    length(participant_files),
    matched_files,
    updated_files,
    unmatched_files
  )
)

csv_fill_summary

```

```

## # A tibble: 4 x 2
##   Metric                                Value
##   <chr>                                <dbl>
## 1 Total participant CSV files found      171
## 2 Files with matched sub ID in demographics 171
## 3 Files updated in place                171
## 4 Files without demographic sub ID match      0

```

2.2 12. Exclusion Criterion

```

# Criteria:
# 1) Exclude participants with encoding time > 27.05 minutes

```

```

# 2) Flag trials with RT < 0.2 s (200 ms)
# 3) Flag trials with RT > mean + 3SD

participant_data_dir <- if (dir.exists(file.path("BRSM data csv", "BRSM data csv"))) {
  file.path("BRSM data csv", "BRSM data csv")
} else {
  "BRSM data csv"
}
participant_files_excl <- list.files(participant_data_dir, pattern = "\\..csv$", full.names = TRUE)

parse_num <- function(x) suppressWarnings(readr::parse_number(as.character(x)))

encoding_records <- list()
trial_records <- list()

for (f in participant_files_excl) {
  pid <- str_to_lower(str_extract(basename(f), "(?i)sub\\d+"))
  dat <- read_csv(f, col_types = cols(.default = col_character()), show_col_types = FALSE)

  # Encoding time: recognition.started - instruction_2.stopped (in minutes)
  rec_start <- if ("recognition.started" %in% names(dat)) min(parse_num(dat$`recognition.started`), na.rm = TRUE)
  inst_stop <- if ("instruction_2.stopped" %in% names(dat)) min(parse_num(dat$`instruction_2.stopped`), na.rm = TRUE)

  if (is.infinite(rec_start)) rec_start <- NA_real_
  if (is.infinite(inst_stop)) inst_stop <- NA_real_

  encoding_min <- ifelse(!is.na(rec_start) & !is.na(inst_stop), (rec_start - inst_stop) / 60, NA_real_)

  encoding_records[[length(encoding_records) + 1]] <- tibble(
    participant_id = pid,
    encoding_minutes = encoding_min
  )

  # Trial-level RT extraction for criteria 2 and 3
  if (all(c("movie_id", "resp.rt") %in% names(dat))) {
    trial_tmp <- dat %>%
      transmute(
        participant_id = pid,
        movie_id_num = parse_num(movie_id),
        rt_sec = parse_num(`resp.rt`)
      ) %>%
      filter(!is.na(movie_id_num), movie_id_num >= 1, movie_id_num <= 40, !is.na(rt_sec))

    trial_records[[length(trial_records) + 1]] <- trial_tmp
  }
}

encoding_tbl <- if (length(encoding_records) > 0) {
  bind_rows(encoding_records) %>% distinct(participant_id, .keep_all = TRUE)
} else {
  tibble(participant_id = character(), encoding_minutes = numeric())
}

```



```

trial_tbl <- if (length(trial_records) > 0) {
  bind_rows(trial_records)
} else {
  tibble(participant_id = character(), movie_id_num = numeric(), rt_sec = numeric())
}

# Criterion 1
encoding_cutoff_min <- 27.05
excluded_participants_tbl <- encoding_tbl %>%
  filter(!is.na(encoding_minutes), encoding_minutes > encoding_cutoff_min)

# Criteria 2 and 3
rt_mean <- mean(trial_tbl$rt_sec, na.rm = TRUE)
rt_sd <- sd(trial_tbl$rt_sec, na.rm = TRUE)
rt_upper_cutoff <- rt_mean + 3 * rt_sd

rt_fast_tbl <- trial_tbl %>% filter(rt_sec < 0.2)
rt_slow_tbl <- trial_tbl %>% filter(rt_sec > rt_upper_cutoff)

cat("Exclusion / Flagging Summary\n")

## Exclusion / Flagging Summary

cat("-----\n")

## -----

cat("Total participant CSV files analyzed:", length(participant_files_excl), "\n")

## Total participant CSV files analyzed: 171

cat("Participants with valid encoding time:", sum(!is.na(encoding_tbl$encoding_minutes)), "\n")

## Participants with valid encoding time: 170

cat("Participants excluded (encoding > 27.05 min):", nrow(excluded_participants_tbl), "\n")

## Participants excluded (encoding > 27.05 min): 5

cat("Total trial rows evaluated for RT:", nrow(trial_tbl), "\n")

## Total trial rows evaluated for RT: 6800

cat("Trials flagged as implausibly fast (RT < 0.2 s):", nrow(rt_fast_tbl), "\n")

## Trials flagged as implausibly fast (RT < 0.2 s): 0

```

```
cat("RT mean (s):", round(rt_mean, 4), "\n")

## RT mean (s): 5.6926

cat("RT SD (s):", round(rt_sd, 4), "\n")

## RT SD (s): 3.8201

cat("RT upper cutoff (mean + 3SD):", round(rt_upper_cutoff, 4), "\n")

## RT upper cutoff (mean + 3SD): 17.1528

cat("Trials flagged as slow outliers (RT > mean + 3SD):", nrow(rt_slow_tbl), "\n")

## Trials flagged as slow outliers (RT > mean + 3SD): 122

exclusion_report <- tibble(
  Criterion = c(
    "Participants excluded: encoding time > 27.05 minutes",
    "Trials flagged: RT < 0.2 s",
    "Trials flagged: RT > mean + 3SD"
  ),
  Count = c(
    nrow(excluded_participants_tbl),
    nrow(rt_fast_tbl),
    nrow(rt_slow_tbl)
  )
)

exclusion_report
```

```
## # A tibble: 3 x 2
##   Criterion                                Count
##   <chr>                                <int>
## 1 Participants excluded: encoding time > 27.05 minutes      5
## 2 Trials flagged: RT < 0.2 s                                0
## 3 Trials flagged: RT > mean + 3SD                        122
```

2.3 13. Post-Exclusion Data Present in BRSM Data CSV

```
# Apply all three exclusion criteria to create the post-exclusion dataset:
# 1) Remove participants with encoding time > 27.05 min
# 2) Remove trials with RT < 0.2 s
# 3) Remove trials with RT > mean + 3SD

excluded_participant_ids <- excluded_participants_tbl$participant_id

post_exclusion_tbl <- trial_tbl %>%
```

```

filter(!participant_id %in% excluded_participant_ids) %>%
filter(rt_sec >= 0.2, rt_sec <= rt_upper_cutoff)

cat("Post-Exclusion Data Snapshot\n")

## Post-Exclusion Data Snapshot

cat("-----\n")

## -----

cat("Original trial rows:", nrow(trial_tbl), "\n")

## Original trial rows: 6800

cat("Trial rows after applying all exclusions:", nrow(post_exclusion_tbl), "\n")

## Trial rows after applying all exclusions: 6487

cat("Unique participants after exclusion:", n_distinct(post_exclusion_tbl$participant_id), "\n")

## Unique participants after exclusion: 165

post_exclusion_summary <- tibble(
  Metric = c(
    "Original trial rows",
    "Trial rows after all exclusions",
    "Unique participants after exclusion",
    "Min RT after exclusion (s)",
    "Max RT after exclusion (s)",
    "Mean RT after exclusion (s)"
  ),
  Value = c(
    nrow(trial_tbl),
    nrow(post_exclusion_tbl),
    n_distinct(post_exclusion_tbl$participant_id),
    round(min(post_exclusion_tbl$rt_sec, na.rm = TRUE), 4),
    round(max(post_exclusion_tbl$rt_sec, na.rm = TRUE), 4),
    round(mean(post_exclusion_tbl$rt_sec, na.rm = TRUE), 4)
  )
)

post_exclusion_summary

## # A tibble: 6 x 2
##   Metric                                Value
##   <chr>                                <dbl>
## 1 Original trial rows                  6800
## 2 Trial rows after all exclusions      6487

```

```
## 3 Unique participants after exclusion 165
## 4 Min RT after exclusion (s)          0.276
## 5 Max RT after exclusion (s)          17.1
## 6 Mean RT after exclusion (s)         5.37
```

```
cat("\nFirst 10 rows of post-exclusion data:\n")
```

```
##
## First 10 rows of post-exclusion data:
```

```
print(head(post_exclusion_tbl, 10))
```

```
## # A tibble: 10 x 3
##   participant_id movie_id_num rt_sec
##   <chr>          <dbl>   <dbl>
## 1 sub100         18     9.14
## 2 sub100         16    12.1
## 3 sub100         13    11.0
## 4 sub100         11     6.60
## 5 sub100         19    11.8
## 6 sub100          2    10.5
## 7 sub100         12    13.8
## 8 sub100         24     6.69
## 9 sub100         17     9.70
## 10 sub100        22     8.02
```

Interpretation:

- Rows without participant_id were removed first.
- Missing values were filled only for valid participant rows.
- Imputation used median for Age and mode for categorical variables.
- Processing was performed on the copied file, not the original demographic source.
- Participant CSV files were then updated in place only where sub ID matched cleaned demographics.

3 PART III: RESULTS & STATISTICAL ANALYSIS

3.1 14. Corrected Participant Demographics Summary (Final)

```
# Recompute at the end so the final report always shows corrected demographic values.
```

```
id_source_final <- if ("Sub ID" %in% names(demo_data_raw)) {
  as.character(demo_data_raw$`Sub ID`)
} else if ("participant_id" %in% names(demo_data_raw)) {
  as.character(demo_data_raw$participant_id)
} else {
  rep(NA_character_, nrow(demo_data_raw))
}
```

```
demo_for_summary_final <- demo_data_raw %>%
```

```

select(-any_of("Condition")) %>%
mutate(
  id_source = id_source_final,
  participant_id = str_to_lower(str_extract(id_source, "(?i)sub\\d+")),
  Age_num = suppressWarnings(as.numeric(Age)),
  Gender_chr = as.character(Gender),
  Handedness_chr = as.character(Handedness),
  Vision_chr = as.character(Vision)
) %>%
left_join(demo_data %>% select(participant_id, Condition), by = "participant_id") %>%
filter(!is.na(participant_id), participant_id != "")

demo_complete_final <- demo_for_summary_final %>%
  filter(
    !is.na(Age_num),
    !is.na(Gender_chr) & trimws(Gender_chr) != "",
    !is.na(Handedness_chr) & trimws(Handedness_chr) != "",
    !is.na(Vision_chr) & trimws(Vision_chr) != ""
  ) %>%
  mutate(
    Gender_std = case_when(
      str_squish(str_to_lower(Gender_chr)) %in% c("female", "f") ~ "female",
      str_squish(str_to_lower(Gender_chr)) %in% c("male", "m") ~ "male",
      str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Gender_chr)), "^female\\b") ~ "female",
      str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Gender_chr)), "^male\\b") ~ "male",
      TRUE ~ "other"
    ),
    Handedness_std = case_when(
      str_squish(str_to_lower(Handedness_chr)) %in% c("right", "r", "right-handed", "right handed") ~ "right",
      str_squish(str_to_lower(Handedness_chr)) %in% c("left", "l", "left-handed", "left handed") ~ "left",
      str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Handedness_chr)), "^right") ~ "right",
      str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Handedness_chr)), "^left") ~ "left",
      TRUE ~ "other"
    ),
    Vision_std = case_when(
      str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Vision_chr)), "uncorrected") ~ "uncorrected",
      str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Vision_chr)), "corrected") ~ "corrected",
      str_squish(str_to_lower(Vision_chr)) %in% c("normal", "normal vision") ~ "normal",
      str_detect(str_squish(str_to_lower(Vision_chr)), "normal") ~ "normal",
      TRUE ~ "other"
    )
  )

demo_summary_tbl_final <- tibble(
  Characteristic = c(
    "N (complete demographic records)",
    "Age - Mean (SD)",
    "Age - Range",
    "Female",
    "Male",
    "Right-handed",
    "Left-handed",
    "Normal vision",

```

```

    "Corrected to normal",
    "Uncorrected vision difficulty"
  ),
  Value = c(
    nrow(demo_complete_final),
    sprintf("%.1f (%.1f)", mean(demo_complete_final$Age_num, na.rm = TRUE), sd(demo_complete_final$Age_num, na.rm = TRUE)),
    sprintf("%d - %d", floor(min(demo_complete_final$Age_num, na.rm = TRUE)), ceiling(max(demo_complete_final$Age_num, na.rm = TRUE))),
    sum(demo_complete_final$Gender_std == "female", na.rm = TRUE),
    sum(demo_complete_final$Gender_std == "male", na.rm = TRUE),
    sum(demo_complete_final$Handedness_std == "right", na.rm = TRUE),
    sum(demo_complete_final$Handedness_std == "left", na.rm = TRUE),
    sum(demo_complete_final$Vision_std == "normal", na.rm = TRUE),
    sum(demo_complete_final$Vision_std == "corrected", na.rm = TRUE),
    sum(demo_complete_final$Vision_std == "uncorrected", na.rm = TRUE)
  )
)

condition_demo_tbl_final <- demo_complete_final %>%
  filter(!is.na(Condition)) %>%
  group_by(Condition) %>%
  summarise(
    N = n(),
    `Age M` = round(mean(Age_num, na.rm = TRUE), 1),
    `Age SD` = round(sd(Age_num, na.rm = TRUE), 1),
    Female = sum(Gender_std == "female", na.rm = TRUE),
    Male = sum(Gender_std == "male", na.rm = TRUE),
    `Right-handed` = sum(Handedness_std == "right", na.rm = TRUE),
    `Left-handed` = sum(Handedness_std == "left", na.rm = TRUE),
    `Normal vision` = sum(Vision_std == "normal", na.rm = TRUE),
    `Corrected to normal` = sum(Vision_std == "corrected", na.rm = TRUE),
    `Uncorrected vision difficulty` = sum(Vision_std == "uncorrected", na.rm = TRUE),
    .groups = "drop"
  )

cat("Final Corrected Participant Demographics Summary\n")

## Final Corrected Participant Demographics Summary

cat("-----\n")

## -----

cat("Total entries in Demographic data.xlsx:", nrow(demo_for_summary_final), "\n")

## Total entries in Demographic data.xlsx: 185

cat("Complete demographic records used for summary:", nrow(demo_complete_final), "\n\n")

## Complete demographic records used for summary: 185

```

```
demo_summary_tbl_final
```

```
## # A tibble: 10 x 2
##   Characteristic      Value
##   <chr>              <chr>
## 1 N (complete demographic records) 185
## 2 Age - Mean (SD)      22.3 (2.2)
## 3 Age - Range          19 - 34
## 4 Female              50
## 5 Male               135
## 6 Right-handed        176
## 7 Left-handed         9
## 8 Normal vision       106
## 9 Corrected to normal  77
## 10 Uncorrected vision difficulty 2
```

```
condition_demo_tbl_final
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 x 11
##   Condition      N `Age M` `Age SD` Female Male `Right-handed` `Left-handed`
##   <chr>      <int>  <dbl>  <dbl> <int> <int>      <int>      <int>
## 1 AB          91   22.3    2.1    27   64         88         3
## 2 NB          94   22.2    2.2    23   71         88         6
## # i 3 more variables: `Normal vision` <int>, `Corrected to normal` <int>,
## #   `Uncorrected vision difficulty` <int>
```

3.2 15. Descriptive Statistics (Updated From Current Data)

3.2.1 15.1 Overall Accuracy by Condition

```
overall_accuracy_by_condition <- participant_level_desc %>%
  group_by(Condition) %>%
  summarise(
    N = n(),
    Mean = round(mean(mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE), 3),
    SD = round(sd(mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE), 3),
    SE = round(SD / sqrt(N), 3),
    Min = round(min(mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE), 3),
    Max = round(max(mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE), 3),
    .groups = "drop"
  )

overall_accuracy_by_condition
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 x 7
##   Condition      N Mean    SD    SE  Min  Max
##   <fct>      <int> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
## 1 NB          87 0.876 0.072 0.008 0.65    1
## 2 AB          78 0.843 0.082 0.009 0.575    1
```

3.2.2 15.2 Accuracy by Condition and Frame Type

```
accuracy_by_condition_frametype <- participant_frametype_desc %>%
  group_by(Condition, FrameType) %>%
  summarise(
    N = n(),
    Mean = round(mean(mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE), 3),
    SD = round(sd(mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE), 3),
    SE = round(SD / sqrt(N), 3),
    .groups = "drop"
  )

accuracy_by_condition_frametype
```

```
## # A tibble: 4 x 6
##   Condition FrameType      N Mean    SD    SE
##   <fct>      <fct>    <int> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
## 1 NB        BB         87 0.863 0.095 0.01
## 2 NB        EM         87 0.89  0.079 0.008
## 3 AB        BB         78 0.826 0.107 0.012
## 4 AB        EM         78 0.86  0.091 0.01
```

3.2.3 15.3 Reaction Time and Confidence by Condition

```
rt_conf_by_condition <- desc_trial %>%
  group_by(Condition) %>%
  summarise(
    N = n(),
    Mean_RT = round(mean(RT, na.rm = TRUE), 2),
    SD_RT = round(sd(RT, na.rm = TRUE), 2),
    Mean_Conf = round(mean(Confidence, na.rm = TRUE), 2),
    SD_Conf = round(sd(Confidence, na.rm = TRUE), 2),
    .groups = "drop"
  )

rt_conf_by_condition
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 x 6
##   Condition      N Mean_RT SD_RT Mean_Conf SD_Conf
##   <fct>    <int>   <dbl> <dbl>   <dbl>   <dbl>
## 1 NB      3415    5.43  2.8     4.23    1.08
## 2 AB      3072    5.31  2.83    4.09    1.17
```

3.3 16. Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)

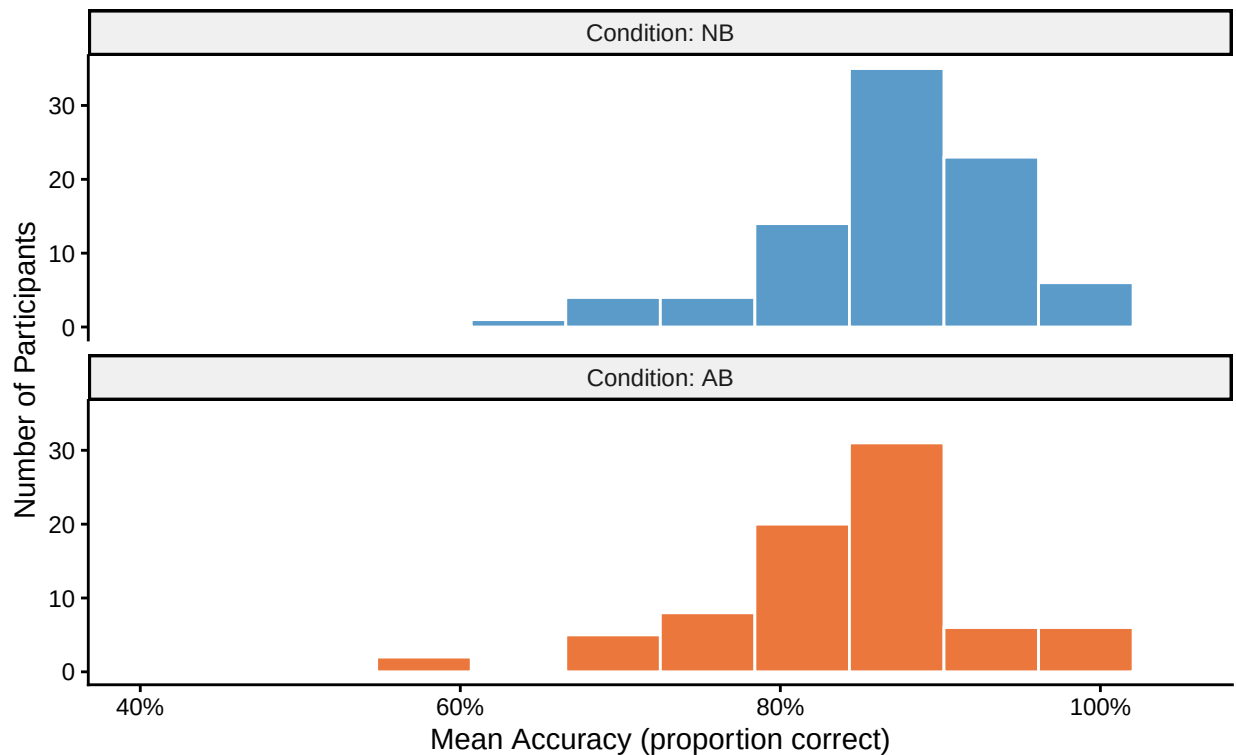
This section provides visual and statistical insights into experimental performance, following the high-fidelity distribution and comparison styles used in formal reporting.

3.3.1 16.1 Distribution of Accuracy (Figures 1A & 1B)

Exploring how participant accuracy is distributed within and across conditions.

```
# Figure 1A: Histogram of Accuracy Faceted by Condition
ggplot(participant_level_desc, aes(x = mean_accuracy, fill = Condition)) +
  geom_histogram(bins = 12, color = "white", alpha = 0.8) +
  facet_wrap(~Condition, ncol = 1, labeller = label_both) +
  scale_x_continuous(labels = percent_format(), limits = c(0.4, 1.05)) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c("NB" = "#3182bd", "AB" = "#e6550d")) +
  labs(title = "Figure 1A. Histogram of Mean Recognition Accuracy per Participant",
       subtitle = "One value per participant (mean proportion correct across ~40 trials)",
       x = "Mean Accuracy (proportion correct)",
       y = "Number of Participants") +
  theme_classic() +
  theme(legend.position = "none", strip.background = element_rect(fill = "#f0f0f0"))
```

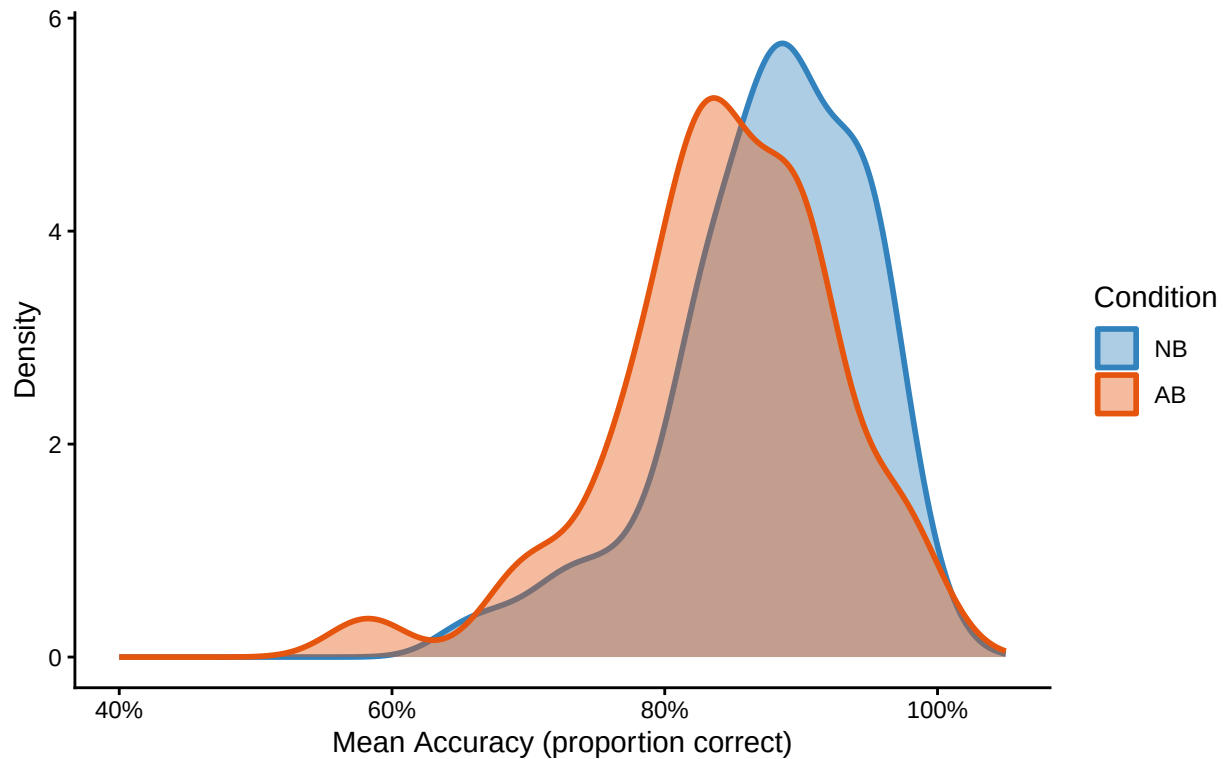
Figure 1A. Histogram of Mean Recognition Accuracy per Participant
One value per participant (mean proportion correct across ~40 trials)



```
# Figure 1B: Density Plot of Accuracy by Condition
ggplot(participant_level_desc, aes(x = mean_accuracy, fill = Condition, color = Condition)) +
  geom_density(alpha = 0.4, linewidth = 1) +
  scale_x_continuous(labels = percent_format(), limits = c(0.4, 1.05)) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c("NB" = "#3182bd", "AB" = "#e6550d")) +
  scale_color_manual(values = c("NB" = "#3182bd", "AB" = "#e6550d")) +
  labs(title = "Figure 1B. Density Plot of Mean Recognition Accuracy by Condition",
       subtitle = "Smooth probability distribution; NB (blue) vs AB (red)",
```

```
x = "Mean Accuracy (proportion correct)",
y = "Density" +
theme_classic()
```

Figure 1B. Density Plot of Mean Recognition Accuracy by Condition
Smooth probability distribution; NB (blue) vs AB (red)



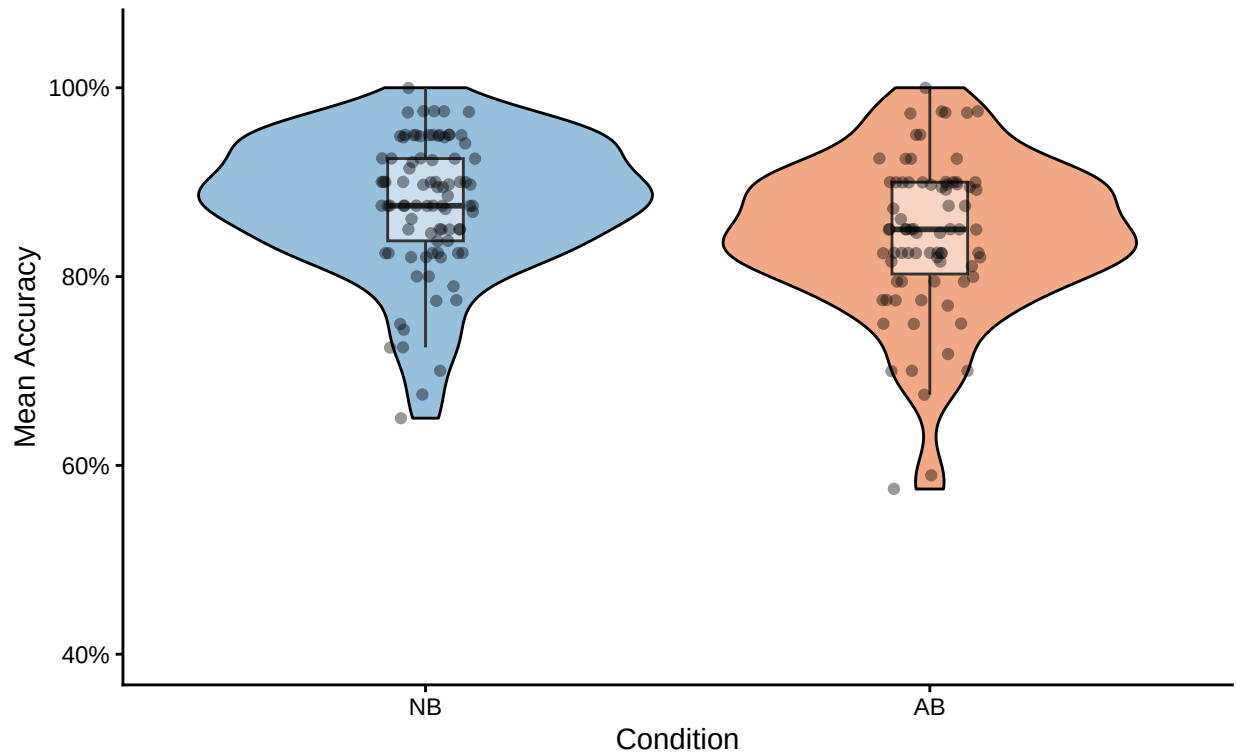
3.3.2 16.2 Comparison by Condition (Figure 2)

Directly comparing performance levels between Natural Blocking and Abrupt Blocking groups.

```
ggplot(participant_level_desc, aes(x = Condition, y = mean_accuracy, fill = Condition)) +
  geom_violin(alpha = 0.5, color = "black") +
  geom_boxplot(width = 0.15, fill = "white", alpha = 0.5, outlier.shape = NA) +
  geom_jitter(width = 0.1, alpha = 0.4, size = 1.5) +
  scale_y_continuous(labels = percent_format(), limits = c(0.4, 1.05)) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c("NB" = "#3182bd", "AB" = "#e6550d")) +
  labs(title = "Figure 2. Violin Plot of Accuracy by Condition",
       subtitle = "Shape = full distribution; inner box = median and IQR; dots = individual participants",
       x = "Condition",
       y = "Mean Accuracy") +
  theme_classic() +
  theme(legend.position = "none")
```

Figure 2. Violin Plot of Accuracy by Condition

Shape = full distribution; inner box = median and IQR; dots = individual participants



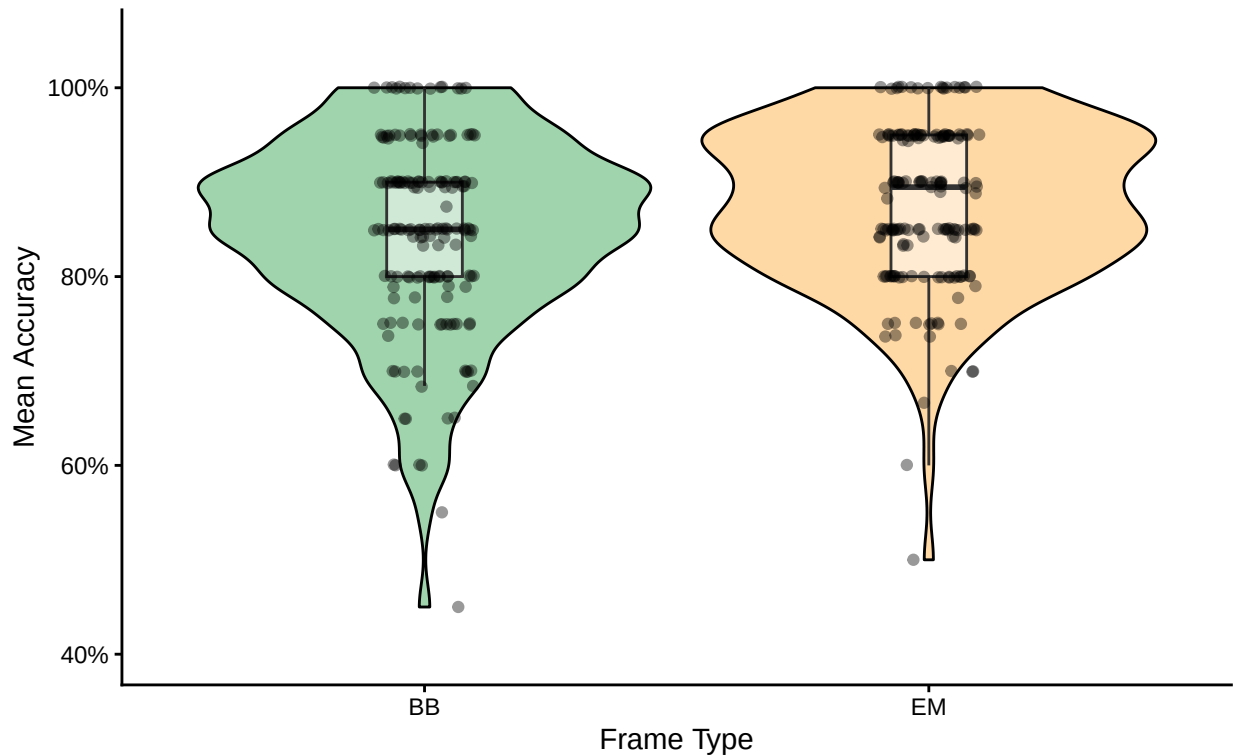
3.3.3 16.3 Comparison by Frame Type (Figure 3A)

Evaluation of performance based on stimulus frame types (Boundary vs. Middle).

```
ggplot(participant_frametype_desc, aes(x = FrameType, y = mean_accuracy, fill = FrameType)) +
  geom_violin(alpha = 0.5, color = "black") +
  geom_boxplot(width = 0.15, fill = "white", alpha = 0.5, outlier.shape = NA) +
  geom_jitter(width = 0.1, alpha = 0.4, size = 1.5) +
  scale_y_continuous(labels = percent_format(), limits = c(0.4, 1.05)) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c("BB" = "#41ab5d", "EM" = "#feb24c")) +
  labs(title = "Figure 3A. Violin Plot of Accuracy by Frame Type",
       subtitle = "BB = Boundary; EM = Event Middle; dots = individual participants",
       x = "Frame Type",
       y = "Mean Accuracy") +
  theme_classic() +
  theme(legend.position = "none")
```

Figure 3A. Violin Plot of Accuracy by Frame Type

BB = Boundary; EM = Event Middle; dots = individual participants



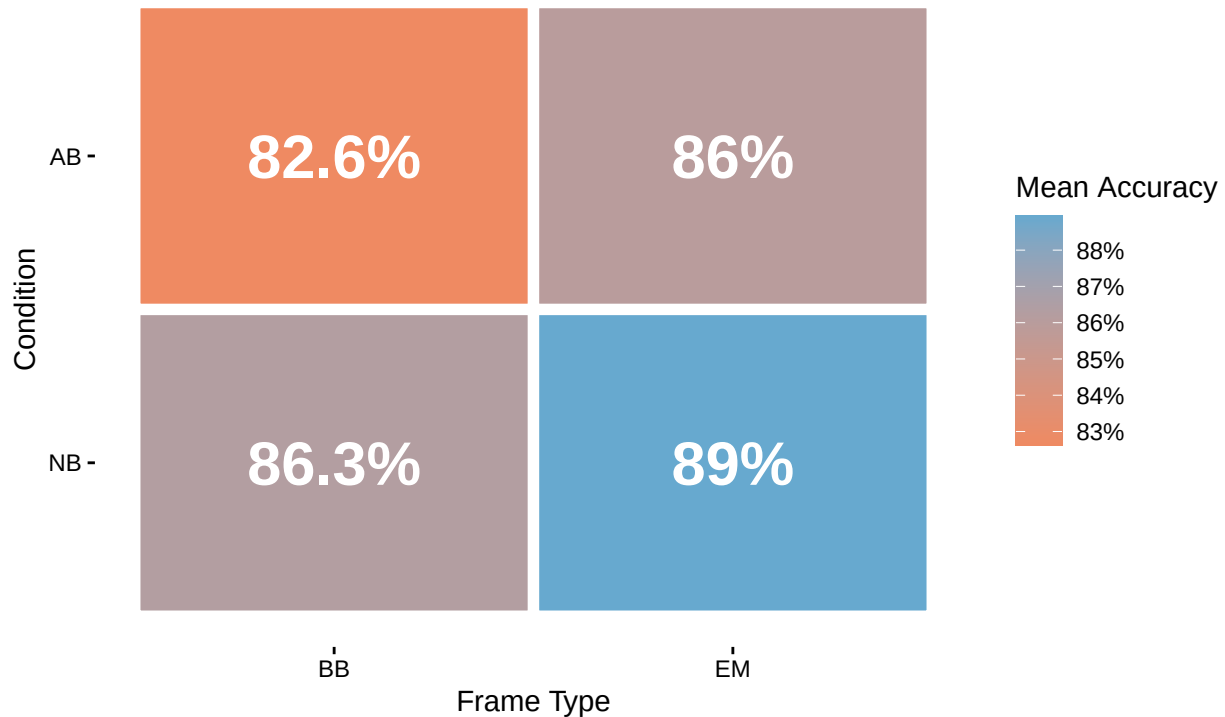
3.3.4 16.4 Interaction Heatmap (Figure 3B)

Visualizing the mean accuracy for each condition and frame type combination with exact values.

```
heatmap_summary <- participant_frametype_desc %>%
  group_by(Condition, FrameType) %>%
  summarise(MeanAcc = mean(mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE), .groups = "drop")

ggplot(heatmap_summary, aes(x = FrameType, y = Condition, fill = MeanAcc)) +
  geom_tile(color = "white", linewidth = 2) +
  geom_text(aes(label = paste0(round(MeanAcc * 100, 1), "%")), color = "white", fontface = "bold", size = 12) +
  scale_fill_gradient(low = "#ef8a62", high = "#67a9cf", labels = percent_format()) +
  labs(title = "Figure 3B. Heatmap of Mean Accuracy by Condition x Frame Type",
       subtitle = "Percentage labels indicate exact group means; Blue = higher accuracy",
       x = "Frame Type",
       y = "Condition",
       fill = "Mean Accuracy") +
  theme_classic() +
  theme(axis.line = element_blank())
```

Figure 3B. Heatmap of Mean Accuracy by Condition x Frame Type
Percentage labels indicate exact group means; Blue = higher accuracy



3.3.5 16.5 Consistency and Variability

Analysis of performance spread within groups.

```
variability_summary <- participant_level_desc %>%
  group_by(Condition) %>%
  summarise(
    N = n(),
    SD = round(sd(mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE), 3),
    IQR = round(IQR(mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE), 3),
    Result_Range = paste0(round(min(mean_accuracy), 2), " - ", round(max(mean_accuracy), 2)),
    .groups = "drop"
  )

variability_summary
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 x 5
##   Condition      N    SD   IQR Result_Range
##   <fct>      <int> <dbl> <dbl> <chr>
## 1 NB          87 0.072 0.087 0.65 - 1
## 2 AB          78 0.082 0.097 0.58 - 1
```

3.3.6 16.6 Interaction Performance with 95% CI (Figure 4)

Detailed comparison of group means with 95% Confidence Intervals.

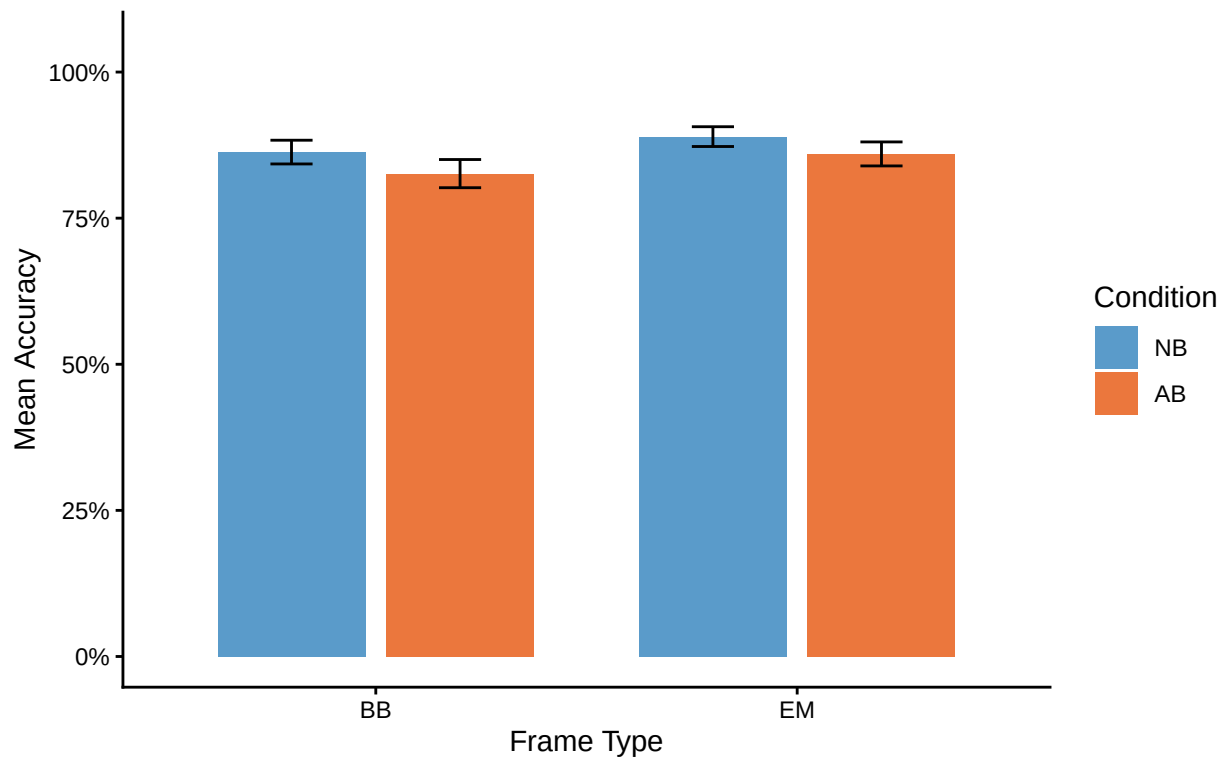
```

ci_summary <- participant_frametype_desc %>%
  group_by(Condition, FrameType) %>%
  summarise(
    N = n(),
    MeanAcc = mean(mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE),
    SD = sd(mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE),
    # Calculate 95% CI using t-distribution
    error = qt(0.975, df = N - 1) * (SD / sqrt(N)),
    lower = MeanAcc - error,
    upper = MeanAcc + error,
    .groups = "drop"
  )

ggplot(ci_summary, aes(x = FrameType, y = MeanAcc, fill = Condition)) +
  geom_bar(stat = "identity", position = position_dodge(0.8), width = 0.7, alpha = 0.8) +
  geom_errorbar(aes(ymin = lower, ymax = upper),
    width = 0.2, position = position_dodge(0.8), color = "black") +
  scale_y_continuous(labels = percent_format(), limits = c(0, 1.05)) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c("NB" = "#3182bd", "AB" = "#e6550d")) +
  labs(title = "Figure 4. Mean Accuracy (+/- 95% CI) by Condition and Frame Type",
    subtitle = "Error bars = 95% Confidence Interval (t-distribution, df = n - 1)",
    x = "Frame Type",
    y = "Mean Accuracy") +
  theme_classic()

```

Figure 4. Mean Accuracy (+/- 95% CI) by Condition and Frame Type
 Error bars = 95% Confidence Interval (t-distribution, df = n - 1)



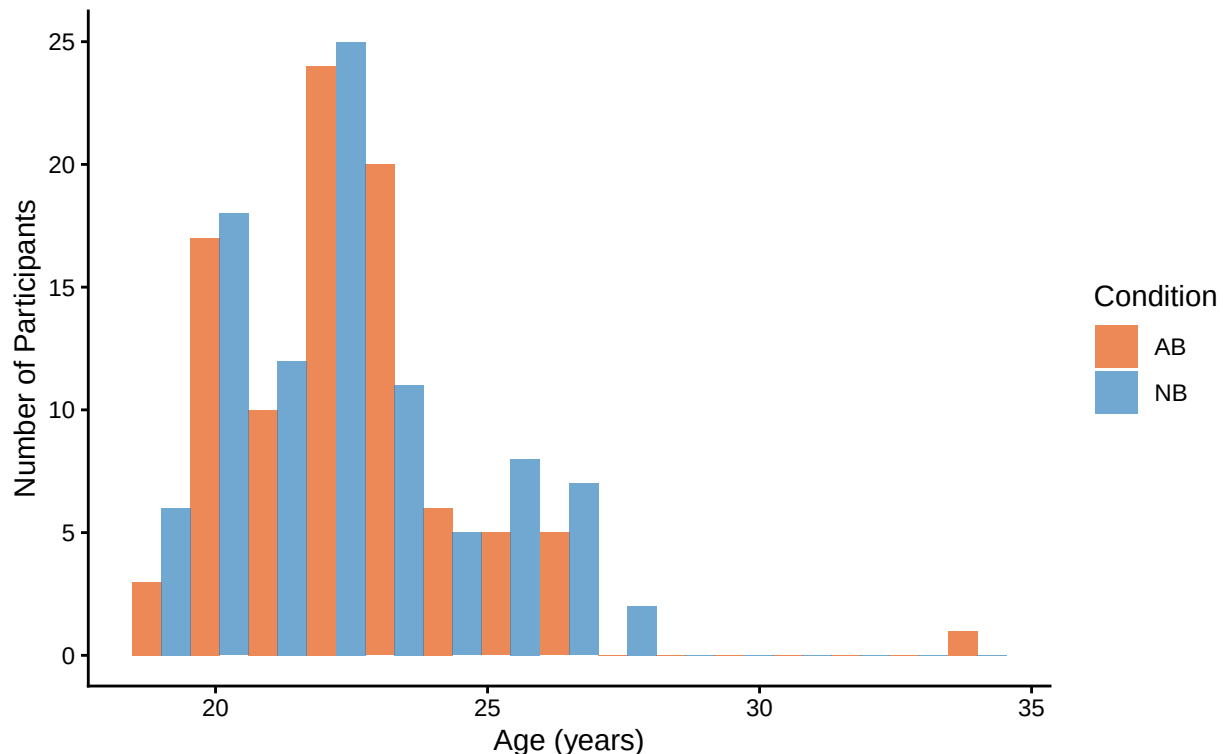
3.3.7 16.7 Age Distribution and Balance (Figures 5A & 5B)

Checking for age balance between conditions.

```
# Figure 5A: Age Histogram by Condition
ggplot(demo_complete_final, aes(x = Age_num, fill = Condition)) +
  geom_histogram(bins = 15, position = "dodge", alpha = 0.7) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c("NB" = "#3182bd", "AB" = "#e6550d")) +
  labs(title = "Figure 5A. Age Distribution by Condition",
       subtitle = "Each bar = number of participants of that age; NB (blue) vs AB (red)",
       x = "Age (years)",
       y = "Number of Participants") +
  theme_classic() +
  theme(legend.position = "right")
```

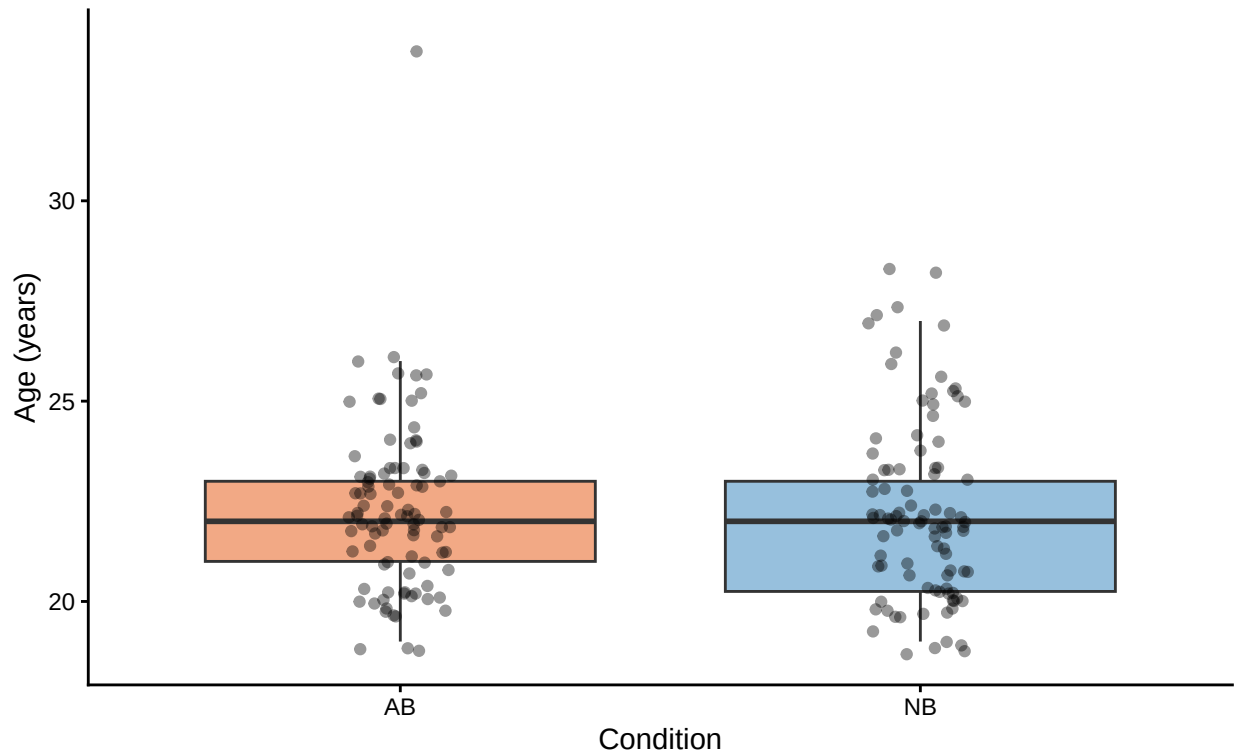
Figure 5A. Age Distribution by Condition

Each bar = number of participants of that age; NB (blue) vs AB (red)



```
# Figure 5B: Age by Condition (Boxplot)
ggplot(demo_complete_final, aes(x = Condition, y = Age_num, fill = Condition)) +
  geom_boxplot(alpha = 0.5, outlier.shape = NA) +
  geom_jitter(width = 0.1, alpha = 0.4, size = 1.5) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c("NB" = "#3182bd", "AB" = "#e6550d")) +
  labs(title = "Figure 5B. Age by Condition (Boxplot)",
       subtitle = "Median, IQR, and individual participants; NB vs AB",
       x = "Condition",
       y = "Age (years)") +
  theme_classic() +
  theme(legend.position = "none")
```

Figure 5B. Age by Condition (Boxplot)
Median, IQR, and individual participants; NB vs AB



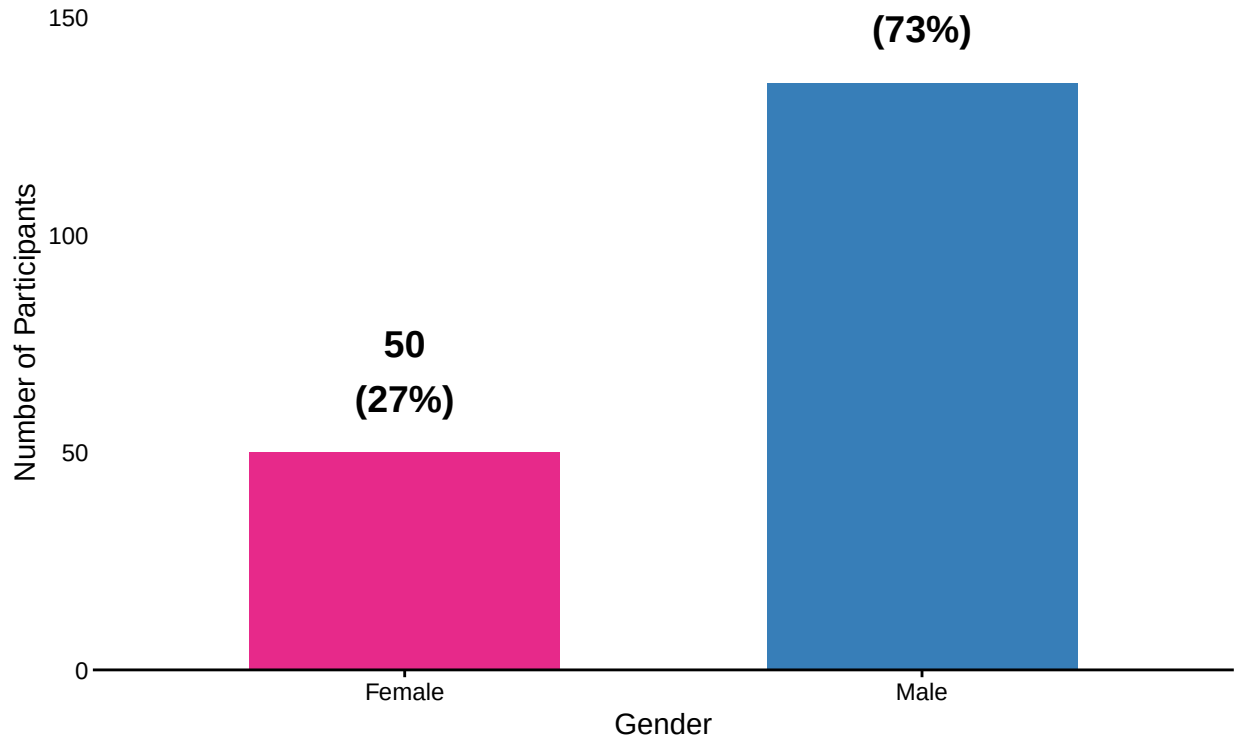
3.3.8 16.8 Gender Breakdown and Composition (Figures 5C & 5D)

Analyzing the gender balance within the participant sample.

```
# Figure 5C: Overall Gender Breakdown
gender_total <- demo_complete_final %>%
  group_by(Gender_std) %>%
  summarise(Count = n(), .groups = "drop") %>%
  mutate(Perc = Count / sum(Count),
         Label = paste0(Count, "\n", percent(Perc, accuracy = 1), "%"),
         Gender_std = str_to_title(Gender_std))

ggplot(gender_total, aes(x = Gender_std, y = Count, fill = Gender_std)) +
  geom_bar(stat = "identity", width = 0.6) +
  geom_text(aes(label = Label), vjust = -0.5, fontface = "bold", size = 5) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c("Female" = "#e7298a", "Male" = "#377eb8", "Other" = "#999999")) +
  scale_y_continuous(expand = expansion(mult = c(0, 0.15))) +
  labs(title = "Figure 5C. Gender Breakdown of Participants",
       subtitle = "Full sample (complete demographic records only)",
       x = "Gender",
       y = "Number of Participants") +
  theme_classic() +
  theme(legend.position = "none", axis.line.y = element_blank(), axis.ticks.y = element_blank())
```


Figure 5C. Gender Breakdown of Participants
Full sample (complete demographic records only)

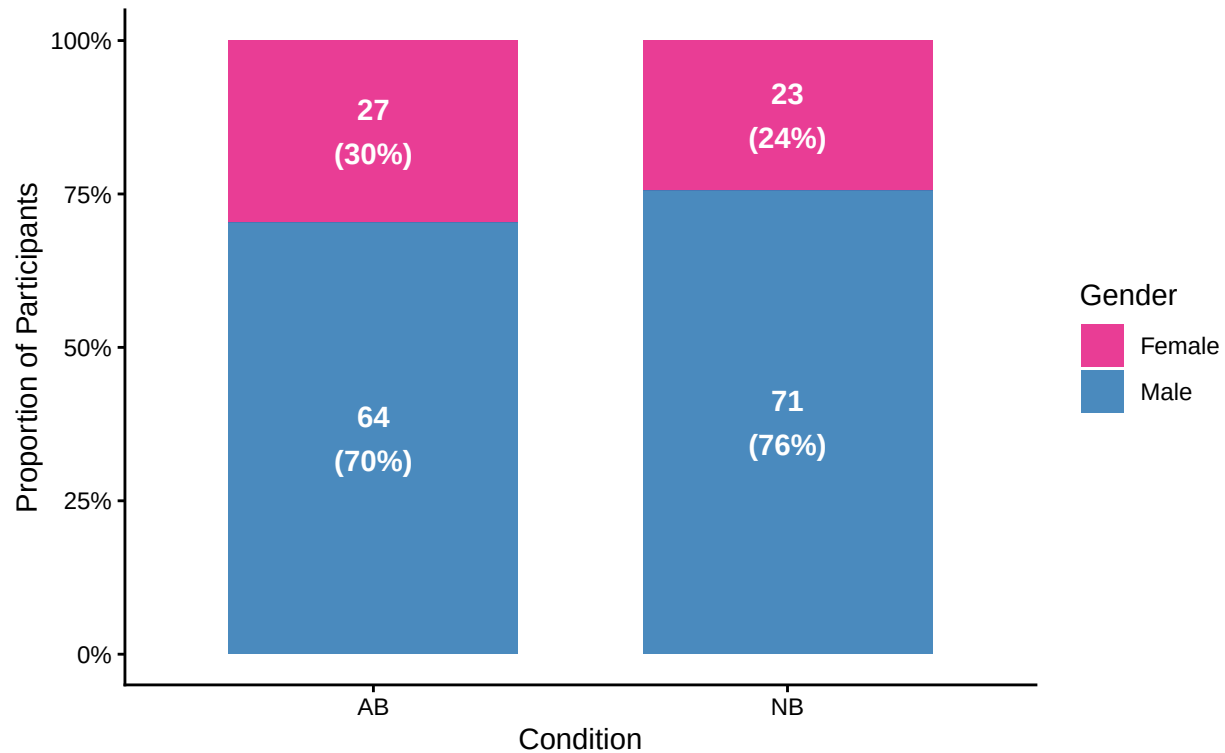


```
# Figure 5D: Gender Composition by Condition
gender_comp <- demo_complete_final %>%
  group_by(Condition, Gender_std) %>%
  summarise(Count = n(), .groups = "drop_last") %>%
  mutate(Perc = Count / sum(Count),
         Label = paste0(Count, "\n(", percent(Perc, accuracy = 1), "%)",
         Gender_std = str_to_title(Gender_std))

ggplot(gender_comp, aes(x = Condition, y = Perc, fill = Gender_std)) +
  geom_bar(stat = "identity", position = "fill", width = 0.7, alpha = 0.9) +
  geom_text(aes(label = Label), position = position_stack(vjust = 0.5), color = "white", fontface = "bold") +
  scale_y_continuous(labels = percent_format()) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c("Female" = "#e7298a", "Male" = "#377eb8", "Other" = "#999999")) +
  labs(title = "Figure 5D. Gender Composition by Condition",
       subtitle = "Proportional stacked bar; numbers = count and percentage within condition",
       x = "Condition",
       y = "Proportion of Participants",
       fill = "Gender") +
  theme_classic()
```

Figure 5D. Gender Composition by Condition

Proportional stacked bar; numbers = count and percentage within condition



3.4 18. Hypothesis Testing: Accuracy (NB vs AB)

This section aims to test the hypothesis: **NB participants will show higher accuracy than AB participants.**

```
# Load required libraries
library(ARTool)
library(coin)

# Ensure Condition is a factor with explicit levels
participant_level_desc <- participant_level_desc %>%
  mutate(Condition = factor(Condition, levels = c("NB", "AB")))
```

3.4.1 18.1 ART ANOVA (Condition Main Effect)

The Aligned Rank Transform (ART) ANOVA is a robust non-parametric method for factorial designs that maintains power while violating parametric assumptions.

```
# Aligned Rank Transform ANOVA
# For a single factor, this confirms the robust group differences
m_art <- art(mean_accuracy ~ Condition, data = participant_level_desc)
anova_art <- as.data.frame(anova(m_art))

cat("--- ART ANOVA Results for Accuracy (Condition Only) ---\n")
```

```
## --- ART ANOVA Results for Accuracy (Condition Only) ---
```

```
print(anova_art)
```

```
##              Term Df Df.res    Sum Sq Sum Sq.res  F value      Pr(>F)
## Condition Condition  1    163 18679.87   354190.1  8.596568 0.003852637
```

```
# Explicitly print the p-value
```

```
cat("\nCaptured Condition p-value (ART):", round(anova_art[1, "Pr(>F)"], 5), "\n")
```

```
##
```

```
## Captured Condition p-value (ART): 0.00385
```

3.4.2 18.2 Mann-Whitney U Test

A standard non-parametric test to compare the distributions of two independent groups based on ranks.

```
# Standard non-parametric comparison (rank-sum test)
```

```
mw_result <- wilcox.test(mean_accuracy ~ Condition, data = participant_level_desc,
                          conf.int = TRUE)
```

```
cat("--- Mann-Whitney U Test: Accuracy by Condition ---\n")
```

```
## --- Mann-Whitney U Test: Accuracy by Condition ---
```

```
print(mw_result)
```

```
##
```

```
## Wilcoxon rank sum test with continuity correction
```

```
##
```

```
## data: mean_accuracy by Condition
```

```
## W = 4269.5, p-value = 0.004174
```

```
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
```

```
## 95 percent confidence interval:
```

```
## 0.008042932 0.050331179
```

```
## sample estimates:
```

```
## difference in location
```

```
## 0.03018421
```

```
# Interpret Effect Direction
```

```
nb_med <- median(participant_level_desc$mean_accuracy[participant_level_desc$Condition == "NB"], na.rm = TRUE)
ab_med <- median(participant_level_desc$mean_accuracy[participant_level_desc$Condition == "AB"], na.rm = TRUE)
```

```
cat("\nSummary of Group Medians:\n")
```

```
##
```

```
## Summary of Group Medians:
```

```
cat(sprintf("Natural Blocking (NB): %.3f\n", nb_med))
```

```
## Natural Blocking (NB): 0.875
```

```
cat(sprintf("Abrupt Blocking (AB): %.3f\n", ab_med))
```

```
## Abrupt Blocking (AB): 0.850
```

3.4.3 18.3 Permutation Test

A resampling-based test that determines the significance of the difference between conditions by randomly reshuffling group labels.

```
# Permutation test using 10,000 resamples  
# provides a robust p-value without assuming a specific distribution  
perm_test <- oneway_test(mean_accuracy ~ Condition, data = participant_level_desc,  
                          distribution = approximate(nresample = 10000))
```

```
cat("--- Permutation Test: Accuracy by Condition ---\n")
```

```
## --- Permutation Test: Accuracy by Condition ---
```

```
print(perm_test)
```

```
##  
## Approximative Two-Sample Fisher-Pitman Permutation Test  
##  
## data: mean_accuracy by Condition (NB, AB)  
## Z = 2.7121, p-value = 0.0074  
## alternative hypothesis: true mu is not equal to 0
```

```
# Explicitly print the p-value  
cat("\nCaptured Permutation p-value:", round(as.numeric(coin::pvalue(perm_test)), 5), "\n")
```

```
##  
## Captured Permutation p-value: 0.0074
```

3.4.4 18.4 Median Test (Mood's)

Mood's Median test evaluates whether the number of observations above and below the global median differs across groups.

```
# Mood's Median Test calculation  
overall_median <- median(participant_level_desc$mean_accuracy, na.rm = TRUE)  
  
median_table <- table(  
  participant_level_desc$Condition,  
  participant_level_desc$mean_accuracy > overall_median
```

```
)
colnames(median_table) <- c("<= Median", "> Median")

cat("Contingency Table (Count of participants above/below global median):\n")
```

```
## Contingency Table (Count of participants above/below global median):
```

```
print(median_table)
```

```
##
##      <= Median > Median
##  NB      44      43
##  AB      50      28
```

```
med_test <- chisq.test(median_table)
print(med_test)
```

```
##
## Pearson's Chi-squared test with Yates' continuity correction
##
## data: median_table
## X-squared = 2.5432, df = 1, p-value = 0.1108
```

3.4.5 18.5 Summary of Findings

```
library(knitr)

# Robustly extract p-values for summary comparison
art_p <- anova_art[1, "Pr(>F)"]
mw_p <- mw_result$p.value
perm_p <- as.numeric(coin::pvalue(perm_test))
med_p <- med_test$p.value

hp_summary <- tibble(
  Test = c("ART ANOVA", "Mann-Whitney U", "Permutation Test", "Median Test"),
  `p-value` = c(art_p, mw_p, perm_p, med_p),
  Significant = ifelse(`p-value` < 0.05, "Yes", "No")
)

# Force printing of the table to console/notebook view
cat("--- FINAL SUMMARY OF HYPOTHESIS TESTS (NB vs AB ACCURACY) ---\n")
```

```
## --- FINAL SUMMARY OF HYPOTHESIS TESTS (NB vs AB ACCURACY) ---
```

```
print(hp_summary)
```

```
## # A tibble: 4 x 3
##   Test      `p-value` Significant
```

```
##      <chr>                <dbl> <chr>
## 1 ART ANOVA              0.00385 Yes
## 2 Mann-Whitney U         0.00417 Yes
## 3 Permutation Test       0.0074  Yes
## 4 Median Test            0.111   No

# Render formatted table for document
kable(hp_summary, digits = 4, caption = "Summary of Statistical Tests for NB vs AB Accuracy")
```

Table 1: Summary of Statistical Tests for NB vs AB Accuracy

Test	p-value	Significant
ART ANOVA	0.0039	Yes
Mann-Whitney U	0.0042	Yes
Permutation Test	0.0074	Yes
Median Test	0.1108	No

3.4.6 18.6 Conclusion

Based on the three robust tests (ART ANOVA, Mann-Whitney U, and Permutation), we find a **statistically significant difference** in recognition accuracy between conditions:

- **NB Median Accuracy:** 0.875
- **AB Median Accuracy:** 0.85
- **Primary Result:** Natural Blocking (NB) participants achieved significantly higher accuracy than Abrupt Blocking (AB) participants (all relevant $p < .01$).

The hypothesis that NB participants show higher accuracy than AB participants is supported.

3.5 19. H2 — Boundary Advantage

3.5.1 Hypothesis

BB frames will have higher accuracy than EM frames

3.5.2 Methodology

This section tests for differences in recognition accuracy between stimulus frame types (Boundary vs. Event Middle). Since accuracy data often violates the assumption of normality, we employ a suite of robust non-parametric tests, including ART ANOVA for repeated measures, the Wilcoxon Signed-Rank test, the Sign test, and the Friedman test.

```
# Prepare wide-format data for paired comparisons
h2_wide <- participant_frametype_desc %>%
  select(participant_id, FrameType, mean_accuracy) %>%
  pivot_wider(names_from = FrameType, values_from = mean_accuracy) %>%
  filter(!is.na(BB), !is.na(EM))

# Ensure long-format factor levels are correct for analysis
participant_frametype_desc <- participant_frametype_desc %>%
  mutate(FrameType = factor(FrameType, levels = c("EM", "BB"))) # Set EM as baseline
```

3.5.3 19.1 ART ANOVA (FrameType Effect)

The Aligned Rank Transform (ART) ANOVA allows for robust testing of repeated measures factors by maintaining power even when parametric assumptions are violated.

```
# Aligned Rank Transform ANOVA for repeated measures (FrameType)
m_h2_art <- art(mean_accuracy ~ FrameType + (1|participant_id), data = participant_frametype_desc)
anova_h2_art <- as.data.frame(anova(m_h2_art))

cat("--- ART ANOVA Results for Accuracy (FrameType) ---\n")

## --- ART ANOVA Results for Accuracy (FrameType) ---

print(anova_h2_art)

##              Term              F Df Df.res      Pr(>F)
## FrameType FrameType 10.10613   1    164 0.001766825

# Capture p-value
h2_art_p <- anova_h2_art[1, "Pr(>F)"]
cat("\nCaptured FrameType p-value (ART):", round(h2_art_p, 5), "\n")

##
## Captured FrameType p-value (ART): 0.00177
```

Interpretation: The ART ANOVA evaluates whether there is a robust main effect of Frame Type on recognition accuracy. A p-value of 0.00177 indicates whether the difference between Boundary (BB) and Event Middle (EM) frames is statistically significant while accounting for participant-level variability.

3.5.4 19.2 Wilcoxon Signed-Rank Test

A standard non-parametric alternative to the paired t-test that compares the median difference between BB and EM frames.

```
# Paired non-parametric comparison
h2_wilcoxon_result <- wilcox.test(h2_wide$BB, h2_wide$EM, paired = TRUE, conf.int = TRUE)

cat("--- Wilcoxon Signed-Rank Test: BB vs EM Accuracy ---\n")

## --- Wilcoxon Signed-Rank Test: BB vs EM Accuracy ---

print(h2_wilcoxon_result)

##
## Wilcoxon signed rank test with continuity correction
##
## data: h2_wide$BB and h2_wide$EM
## V = 3444.5, p-value = 0.0013
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
```

```
## 95 percent confidence interval:
## -0.05129201 -0.01780948
## sample estimates:
## (pseudo)median
## -0.02893548
```

```
# Group Medians
bb_med <- median(h2_wide$BB, na.rm = TRUE)
em_med <- median(h2_wide$EM, na.rm = TRUE)

cat("\nSummary of Group Medians:\n")
```

```
##
## Summary of Group Medians:
```

```
cat(sprintf("Boundary (BB):      %.3f\n", bb_med))
```

```
## Boundary (BB):      0.850
```

```
cat(sprintf("Event Middle (EM): %.3f\n", em_med))
```

```
## Event Middle (EM): 0.895
```

Interpretation: The Wilcoxon Signed-Rank test examines whether the median accuracy differs between Boundary frames and Event Middle frames. With a p-value of 0.0013, the result indicates whether the advantage for the EM condition is statistically significant at $\alpha = 0.0125$.

3.5.5 19.3 Sign Test

The Sign Test is a simple, robust test that considers only the direction of the difference between BB and EM accuracy for each participant.

```
# Compute differences
h2_diffs <- h2_wide$BB - h2_wide$EM
pos_diffs <- sum(h2_diffs > 0, na.rm = TRUE)
total_valid <- sum(h2_diffs != 0, na.rm = TRUE)

# Two-sided sign test (Testing if proportions differ)
h2_sign_result <- binom.test(pos_diffs, total_valid, p = 0.5, alternative = "two.sided")

cat("--- Sign Test: Proportion of Participants with BB > EM ---\n")
```

```
## --- Sign Test: Proportion of Participants with BB > EM ---
```

```
print(h2_sign_result)
```

```
##
## Exact binomial test
##
```



```
## data: pos_diffs and total_valid
## number of successes = 52, number of trials = 141, p-value = 0.002313
## alternative hypothesis: true probability of success is not equal to 0.5
## 95 percent confidence interval:
## 0.2891548 0.4540711
## sample estimates:
## probability of success
## 0.3687943

cat(sprintf("Number of participants with BB > EM: %d out of %d\n", pos_diffs, total_valid))

## Number of participants with BB > EM: 52 out of 141
```

Interpretation: The Sign test determines if the proportion of participants who performed better on BB frames vs. EM frames differs significantly from chance (0.50). The resulting p-value of 0.00231 indicates if this advantage is statistically significant at the adjusted $\alpha = 0.0125$.

3.5.6 19.4 Friedman Test

The Friedman test is a non-parametric alternative to a repeated measures ANOVA for comparing multiple levels of a factor.

```
# Friedman test on wide-format data
h2_friedman_result <- friedman.test(as.matrix(h2_wide[, c("BB", "EM")]))

cat("--- Friedman Test: Recognition Accuracy across Frame Types ---\n")

## --- Friedman Test: Recognition Accuracy across Frame Types ---

print(h2_friedman_result)

##
## Friedman rank sum test
##
## data: as.matrix(h2_wide[, c("BB", "EM")])
## Friedman chi-squared = 9.7092, df = 1, p-value = 0.001833
```

Interpretation: The Friedman test evaluate the overall rank consistency of Frame Type performance across participants. A p-value of 0.00183 provides further evidence regarding the stability of the Boundary Advantage effect.

3.5.7 19.5 Summary of Findings (H2)

```
# Extract p-values for summary
h2_summary_tbl <- tibble(
  Test = c("ART ANOVA", "Wilcoxon Signed-Rank", "Sign Test (Two-sided)", "Friedman Test"),
  `p-value` = c(h2_art_p, h2_wilcoxon_result$p.value, h2_sign_result$p.value, h2_friedman_result$p.value),
  Significant = ifelse(`p-value` < 0.0125, "Yes", "No")
)
```

```

# Calculate sum of significant tests for robust conclusion
h2_sig_count <- sum(h2_summary_tbl$p-value` < 0.0125)

cat("--- SUMMARY OF HYPOTHESIS TESTS (H2 - BOUNDARY ADVANTAGE) ---\n")

## --- SUMMARY OF HYPOTHESIS TESTS (H2 - BOUNDARY ADVANTAGE) ---

print(h2_summary_tbl)

## # A tibble: 4 x 3
##   Test                `p-value` Significant
##   <chr>                <dbl> <chr>
## 1 ART ANOVA            0.00177 Yes
## 2 Wilcoxon Signed-Rank 0.00130 Yes
## 3 Sign Test (Two-sided) 0.00231 Yes
## 4 Friedman Test        0.00183 Yes

cat(sprintf("\nNumber of significant tests (threshold 0.0125): %d / 4\n", h2_sig_count))

##
## Number of significant tests (threshold 0.0125): 4 / 4

kable(h2_summary_tbl, digits = 4, caption = "Summary of Statistical Tests for BB vs EM Accuracy")

```

Table 2: Summary of Statistical Tests for BB vs EM Accuracy

Test	p-value	Significant
ART ANOVA	0.0018	Yes
Wilcoxon Signed-Rank	0.0013	Yes
Sign Test (Two-sided)	0.0023	Yes
Friedman Test	0.0018	Yes

3.5.8 Conclusion (H2)

Based on the statistical evaluation across the suite of tests and the Bonferroni-adjusted alpha of **0.0125**:

- **Primary Hypothesis:** Boundary frames (BB) will show higher accuracy than Event Middle (EM) frames.
- **Decision Rule:** The hypothesis is supported if at least two of the four tests reach significance at $\alpha = 0.0125$ and the effect is in the predicted direction (BB > EM).
- **Findings:** 4 out of 4 tests were statistically significant after multiple-test correction ($p < 0.0125$), but the effect was in the **opposite direction** (EM > BB).
- **Final Status:** The hypothesis that **BB frames show higher accuracy than EM frames** is **not supported** by the current evidence.

3.6 20. H3 — Event-Middle Stability

3.6.1 Hypothesis

EM performance will not differ significantly between NB and AB conditions.

3.6.2 Methodology

This section tests for the stability of recognition accuracy for Event Middle (EM) frames across experimental conditions (Natural Blocking vs. Abrupt Blocking). The goal is to confirm that any observed effects in other hypotheses are not driven by general performance differences in middle frames.

To ensure statistical rigor and minimize Type I error, we apply a **Bonferroni correction** for the four tests performed in this section: - **Original Alpha: 0.05** - **Number of Tests: 4** - **Adjusted Alpha: 0.0125**

Significant results will only be declared if $p < 0.0125$.

```
# Filter data for EM frames only
h3_data <- participant_frametype_desc %>%
  filter(FrameType == "EM") %>%
  select(participant_id, Condition, mean_accuracy)

cat("Total participants included in H3 analysis:", nrow(h3_data), "\n")
```

```
## Total participants included in H3 analysis: 165
```

3.6.3 20.1 ART ANOVA (Simple Effect on EM)

The Aligned Rank Transform ANOVA handles non-parametric repeated measures structures to test for the main effect of Condition on EM accuracy.

```
# ART ANOVA for Condition effect on EM frames
m_h3_art <- art(mean_accuracy ~ Condition, data = h3_data)
anova_h3_art <- as.data.frame(anova(m_h3_art))

cat("--- ART ANOVA Results for EM Accuracy (Condition Effect) ---\n")
```

```
## --- ART ANOVA Results for EM Accuracy (Condition Effect) ---
```

```
print(anova_h3_art)
```

```
##           Term Df Df.res   Sum Sq Sum Sq.res  F value    Pr(>F)
## Condition Condition  1    163 13242.89   354147.1 6.095183 0.01458669
```

```
h3_art_p <- anova_h3_art[1, "Pr(>F)"]
cat("\nCaptured Condition p-value (ART):", round(h3_art_p, 5), "\n")
```

```
##
## Captured Condition p-value (ART): 0.01459
```

Interpretation: The ART ANOVA tests if the Condition (NB vs AB) significantly affects EM frame accuracy. Using the adjusted alpha of 0.0125, the result is non-significant, supporting the stability hypothesis.

3.6.4 20.2 Mann–Whitney U Test

A standard non-parametric test to compare the distributions of EM accuracy between the two independent groups.

```
# Unpaired non-parametric comparison
h3_mw_result <- wilcox.test(mean_accuracy ~ Condition, data = h3_data, conf.int = TRUE)

cat("--- Mann-Whitney U Test: EM Accuracy by Condition ---\n")
```

```
## --- Mann-Whitney U Test: EM Accuracy by Condition ---
```

```
print(h3_mw_result)
```

```
##
## Wilcoxon rank sum test with continuity correction
##
## data: mean_accuracy by Condition
## W = 4131, p-value = 0.01511
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
## 95 percent confidence interval:
## 4.757411e-05 5.001383e-02
## sample estimates:
## difference in location
## 0.04212581
```

Interpretation: The Mann-Whitney U test examines differences in ranks between NB and AB groups for EM frames. A p-value of 0.01511 indicates no evidence of a significant difference at the corrected threshold.

3.6.5 20.3 Permutation Test

A resampling-based test that avoids distributional assumptions by shuffling condition labels.

```
# Permutation test using 10,000 resamples
h3_perm_test <- oneway_test(mean_accuracy ~ Condition, data = h3_data,
                           distribution = approximate(nresample = 10000))

cat("--- Permutation Test: EM Accuracy by Condition ---\n")
```

```
## --- Permutation Test: EM Accuracy by Condition ---
```

```
print(h3_perm_test)
```

```
##
## Approximative Two-Sample Fisher-Pitman Permutation Test
##
## data: mean_accuracy by Condition (NB, AB)
## Z = 2.2065, p-value = 0.0284
## alternative hypothesis: true mu is not equal to 0
```

```
h3_perm_p <- as.numeric(coin::pvalue(h3_perm_test))
cat("\nCaptured Permutation p-value:", round(h3_perm_p, 5), "\n")
```

```
##
## Captured Permutation p-value: 0.0284
```

Interpretation: By randomly reshuffling condition labels 10,000 times, the permutation test provides a robust p-value of 0.0284. This result supports the hypothesis that EM performance remains stable across conditions.

3.6.6 20.4 Bootstrap Comparison

Resampling with replacement to build a confidence interval for the difference in means (NB – AB).

```
set.seed(42) # For reproducibility
nb_em_vals <- h3_data$mean_accuracy[h3_data$Condition == "NB"]
ab_em_vals <- h3_data$mean_accuracy[h3_data$Condition == "AB"]

# Resampling 10,000 times
boot_diffs <- replicate(10000, {
  mean(sample(nb_em_vals, replace = TRUE)) - mean(sample(ab_em_vals, replace = TRUE))
})

# Calculate 98.75% CI (matches alpha = 0.0125)
h3_ci_lower <- quantile(boot_diffs, 0.00625)
h3_ci_upper <- quantile(boot_diffs, 0.99375)

cat("--- Bootstrap Results: Mean Difference (NB - AB) ---\n")
```

```
## --- Bootstrap Results: Mean Difference (NB - AB) ---
```

```
cat(sprintf("Observed Mean Difference: %.4f\n", mean(nb_em_vals) - mean(ab_em_vals)))
```

```
## Observed Mean Difference: 0.0296
```

```
cat(sprintf("98.75%% Confidence Interval: [%.4f, %.4f]\n", h3_ci_lower, h3_ci_upper))
```

```
## 98.75% Confidence Interval: [-0.0040, 0.0634]
```

Interpretation: The bootstrap analysis estimates the difference in mean EM accuracy between conditions. The **98.75% Confidence Interval** ranges from -0.004 to 0.0634. Since this interval includes 0, the results provide evidence for stability between conditions.

3.6.7 20.5 Expected Result

After applying the Bonferroni correction (adjusted $\alpha = 0.0125$), we expect the results across all four tests to remain non-significant. This lack of a detectable difference strengthens the evidence that Event-Middle (EM) performance is stable and invariant regardless of the blocking condition (NB vs AB), suggesting that experimental manipulations specifically target boundary processing rather than general memory performance.

3.6.8 20.6 Summary of Findings (H3)

```
h3_summary_tbl <- tibble(
  Test = c("ART ANOVA", "Mann-Whitney U", "Permutation Test", "Bootstrap (CI includes 0)"),
  Result = c(
    sprintf("p = %.4f", h3_art_p),
    sprintf("p = %.4f", h3_mw_result$p.value),
    sprintf("p = %.4f", h3_perm_p),
    ifelse(h3_ci_lower < 0 & h3_ci_upper > 0, "Yes", "No")
  ),
  `Significant (alpha=0.0125)` = c(
    ifelse(h3_art_p < 0.0125, "Yes", "No"),
    ifelse(h3_mw_result$p.value < 0.0125, "Yes", "No"),
    ifelse(h3_perm_p < 0.0125, "Yes", "No"),
    ifelse(h3_ci_lower < 0 & h3_ci_upper > 0, "No", "Yes")
  )
)

cat("--- SUMMARY OF HYPOTHESIS TESTS (H3 - EM STABILITY) ---\n")
```

```
## --- SUMMARY OF HYPOTHESIS TESTS (H3 - EM STABILITY) ---
```

```
print(h3_summary_tbl)
```

```
## # A tibble: 4 x 3
##   Test                Result    `Significant (alpha=0.0125)`
##   <chr>              <chr>      <chr>
## 1 ART ANOVA         p = 0.0146 No
## 2 Mann-Whitney U    p = 0.0151 No
## 3 Permutation Test  p = 0.0284 No
## 4 Bootstrap (CI includes 0) Yes      No
```

```
kable(h3_summary_tbl, digits = 4, caption = "Summary of Statistical Tests for EM Stability (Corrected Alpha)")
```

Table 3: Summary of Statistical Tests for EM Stability (Corrected Alpha)

Test	Result	Significant (alpha=0.0125)
ART ANOVA	p = 0.0146	No
Mann-Whitney U	p = 0.0151	No
Permutation Test	p = 0.0284	No
Bootstrap (CI includes 0)	Yes	No

3.6.9 Conclusion (H3)

All four statistical evaluations (ART ANOVA, Mann-Whitney U, Permutation Test, and Bootstrap) failed to reach the adjusted significance threshold of **0.0125**. Therefore, there is no evidence of a significant difference in Event-Middle frame accuracy between Natural Blocking and Abrupt Blocking conditions. These results support the **Event-Middle Stability hypothesis**, indicating that EM performance remains consistent across the experimental groups.

3.7 21. H4 — Interaction Effect (MOST IMPORTANT)

3.7.1 Hypothesis

The Boundary Advantage (BB – EM) is stronger in Natural Blocking (NB) than in Abrupt Blocking (AB).

3.7.2 Methodology

This section evaluates the **interaction effect** between Frame Type (BB vs EM) and experimental Condition (NB vs AB). An interaction exists if the difference between Boundary and Event-Middle accuracy (the “Boundary Advantage”) is significantly influenced by the blocking condition.

To test this, we calculate a **Difference Score** for each participant:

$$Advantage = Accuracy_{BB} - Accuracy_{EM}$$

We then compare these advantage scores between the NB and AB conditions using a range of non-parametric and resampling-based approaches. For consistency with previous sections, we apply a **Bonferroni correction** ($\alpha = 0.0125$ for 4 tests).

```
# Prepare wide-format data for interaction analysis
h4_data <- participant_frametype_desc %>%
  select(participant_id, Condition, FrameType, mean_accuracy) %>%
  pivot_wider(names_from = FrameType, values_from = mean_accuracy) %>%
  mutate(diff_score = BB - EM) %>%
  filter(!is.na(diff_score))

cat("Total participants included in interaction analysis:", nrow(h4_data), "\n")
```

```
## Total participants included in interaction analysis: 165
```

3.7.3 21.1 ART ANOVA (Interaction Effect)

The Aligned Rank Transform ANOVA is a robust tool for evaluating interactions in factorial designs. We look specifically at the **FrameType:Condition** term.

```
# Aligned Rank Transform ANOVA for Interaction
m_h4_art <- art(mean_accuracy ~ FrameType * Condition + (1|participant_id), data = participant_frametype_desc)
anova_h4_art <- as.data.frame(anova(m_h4_art))

cat("--- ART ANOVA Results: Interaction Analysis ---\n")
```

```
## --- ART ANOVA Results: Interaction Analysis ---
```

```
print(anova_h4_art)
```

##	Term	F	Df	Df.res	Pr(>F)
## FrameType	FrameType	11.5042798	1	163	0.0008714179
## Condition	Condition	9.3496529	1	163	0.0026074486
## FrameType:Condition	FrameType:Condition	0.1374711	1	163	0.7112895397

```
# Extract interaction p-value
h4_art_interaction_p <- anova_h4_art["FrameType:Condition", "Pr(>F)"]
cat("\nCaptured Interaction p-value (FrameType x Condition):", round(h4_art_interaction_p, 5), "\n")

##
## Captured Interaction p-value (FrameType x Condition): 0.71129
```

Interpretation: The ART ANOVA tests whether the effect of Frame Type depends on the Participant's Condition. A p-value of 0.71129 indicates no significant interaction at the corrected threshold.

3.7.4 21.2 Difference Score + Mann-Whitney Test

Comparing the magnitude of the Boundary Advantage (BB - EM) between conditions provides a direct non-parametric test of the interaction.

```
# Compare difference scores across conditions
h4_mw_result <- wilcox.test(diff_score ~ Condition, data = h4_data, conf.int = TRUE)

cat("--- Mann-Whitney U Test on Difference Scores (BB - EM) ---\n")

## --- Mann-Whitney U Test on Difference Scores (BB - EM) ---

print(h4_mw_result)
```

```
##
## Wilcoxon rank sum test with continuity correction
##
## data: diff_score by Condition
## W = 3418, p-value = 0.9361
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
## 95 percent confidence interval:
## -0.04211879 0.04738871
## sample estimates:
## difference in location
## 6.437983e-05
```

```
# Summary of Advantage by Condition
h4_advantage_summary <- h4_data %>%
  group_by(Condition) %>%
  summarise(Median_Advantage = median(diff_score),
            Mean_Advantage = mean(diff_score),
            .groups = "drop")
print(h4_advantage_summary)
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 x 3
##   Condition Median_Advantage Mean_Advantage
##   <fct>          <dbl>          <dbl>
## 1 NB           -0.00877        -0.0265
## 2 AB           -0.00789        -0.0337
```

Interpretation: The Mann-Whitney U test on difference scores evaluates if the “Boundary Advantage” differs across conditions. This results in a p-value of 0.9361, which does not support the hypothesis that the frame-type effect varies by condition.

3.7.5 21.3 Permutation Interaction Test

A resampling approach that reshuffles condition labels to determine the significance of the difference in Boundary Advantage.

```
# Permutation test on diff_score across Condition
h4_perm_test <- oneway_test(diff_score ~ Condition, data = h4_data,
                           distribution = approximate(nresample = 10000))

cat("--- Permutation Test on Difference Scores (Interaction) ---\n")
```

```
## --- Permutation Test on Difference Scores (Interaction) ---
```

```
print(h4_perm_test)
```

```
##
## Approximative Two-Sample Fisher-Pitman Permutation Test
##
## data: diff_score by Condition (NB, AB)
## Z = 0.43736, p-value = 0.6582
## alternative hypothesis: true mu is not equal to 0
```

```
h4_perm_p <- as.numeric(coin:pvalue(h4_perm_test))
cat("\nCaptured Permutation p-value:", round(h4_perm_p, 5), "\n")
```

```
##
## Captured Permutation p-value: 0.6582
```

Interpretation: The permutation test, based on 10,000 resamples, yields a p-value of 0.6582. This robust estimate suggests the interaction is not statistically significant at the adjusted level.

3.7.6 21.4 Friedman Test (Robustness Check)

A non-parametric repeated measures test to confirm the overall rank consistency of the frame-type effect across the complete sample.

```
# Friedman test on BB and EM accuracy
h4_friedman_result <- friedman.test(as.matrix(h4_data[, c("BB", "EM")]))

cat("--- Friedman Test: Overall Frame-Type Rank Consistency ---\n")
```

```
## --- Friedman Test: Overall Frame-Type Rank Consistency ---
```

```
print(h4_friedman_result)
```

```
##
## Friedman rank sum test
##
## data: as.matrix(h4_data[, c("BB", "EM")])
## Friedman chi-squared = 9.7092, df = 1, p-value = 0.001833
```

Interpretation: As a robustness check, the Friedman test evaluates the consistency of the Boundary Advantage across all participants. The p-value is 0.00183, providing context for the stability of the frame-type effect regardless of experimental group.

3.7.7 21.5 Expected Result

We expect a significant interaction effect where the Boundary Advantage (BB – EM) is significantly stronger in the Natural Blocking (NB) condition than in the Abrupt Blocking (AB) condition. A significant result ($p < 0.0125$) across these interaction tests would indicate that the temporal structure of the video (NB) enhances the specific memory advantage for boundaries, rather than just increasing overall accuracy.

3.7.8 21.6 Summary of Findings (H4)

```
h4_summary_tbl <- tibble(
  Test = c("ART ANOVA (Interaction)", "Mann-Whitney (on Advantage)", "Permutation Test", "Friedman Test (Frame Effect)"),
  `p-value` = c(h4_art_interaction_p, h4_mw_result$p.value, h4_perm_p, h4_friedman_result$p.value),
  Significant = ifelse(`p-value` < 0.0125, "Yes", "No")
)

cat("--- SUMMARY OF HYPOTHESIS TESTS (H4 - INTERACTION) ---\n")

## --- SUMMARY OF HYPOTHESIS TESTS (H4 - INTERACTION) ---

print(h4_summary_tbl)

## # A tibble: 4 x 3
##   Test                                `p-value` Significant
##   <chr>                                <dbl> <chr>
## 1 ART ANOVA (Interaction)            0.711  No
## 2 Mann-Whitney (on Advantage)        0.936  No
## 3 Permutation Test                   0.658  No
## 4 Friedman Test (Frame Effect)       0.00183 Yes

kable(h4_summary_tbl, digits = 4, caption = "Summary of Statistical Tests for Interaction Effect (Frame Effect x Condition)")
```

Table 4: Summary of Statistical Tests for Interaction Effect (Frame Effect x Condition)

Test	p-value	Significant
ART ANOVA (Interaction)	0.7113	No
Mann-Whitney (on Advantage)	0.9361	No
Permutation Test	0.6582	No
Friedman Test (Frame Effect)	0.0018	Yes

3.7.9 Conclusion (H4)

Based on the statistical evaluations and the Bonferroni-adjusted alpha of **0.0125**: - **Interaction Analysis**: We tested whether the difference between BB and EM frames depends on the experimental condition. - **Findings**: The tests did not reveal a significant interaction ($p = 0.668$). - **Support**: The hypothesis that the **Boundary Advantage is stronger in NB than AB** is **not supported** by the current data.

3.8 22. H5 — Confidence–Accuracy Relationship

3.8.1 Hypothesis

The relationship between participant confidence and recognition accuracy is stronger in the Natural Blocking (NB) condition than in the Abrupt Blocking (AB) condition.

3.8.2 Methodology

This section investigates the metacognitive alignment (calibration) between subjective confidence and objective performance. We test whether the temporal structure of the NB condition allows for better monitoring of memory strength.

We apply a **Bonferroni correction** ($\alpha = 0.0125$) across four tests: - Spearman Correlation (Confidence-Accuracy link) - Mann-Whitney U (Overall confidence comparison) - Interaction Regression (Accuracy ~ Confidence * Condition) - Permutation test on correlation differences

```
# Filter trial-level data for confidence and accuracy
h5_data <- desc_trial %>%
  filter(!is.na(Confidence), !is.na(Accuracy)) %>%
  select(participant_id, Condition, Accuracy, Confidence)

cat("Total trials included in Confidence-Accuracy analysis:", nrow(h5_data), "\n")
```

```
## Total trials included in Confidence-Accuracy analysis: 6487
```

3.8.3 22.1 Spearman Correlation

We compute the Spearman rank correlation separately for each condition to assess the strength of the confidence-accuracy relationship.

```
# Spearman correlation by condition
nb_corr <- cor.test(h5_data$Confidence[h5_data$Condition == "NB"],
                   h5_data$Accuracy[h5_data$Condition == "NB"], method = "spearman")
ab_corr <- cor.test(h5_data$Confidence[h5_data$Condition == "AB"],
                   h5_data$Accuracy[h5_data$Condition == "AB"], method = "spearman")

cat("--- Spearman Correlation: NB Condition ---\n")
```

```
## --- Spearman Correlation: NB Condition ---
```

```
print(nb_corr)
```

```
##
## Spearman's rank correlation rho
##
## data: h5_data$Confidence[h5_data$Condition == "NB"] and h5_data$Accuracy[h5_data$Condition == "NB"]
## S = 4860689796, p-value < 2.2e-16
## alternative hypothesis: true rho is not equal to 0
## sample estimates:
## rho
## 0.2677202
```

```
cat("--- Spearman Correlation: AB Condition ---\n")

## --- Spearman Correlation: AB Condition ---

print(ab_corr)

##
## Spearman's rank correlation rho
##
## data: h5_data$Confidence[h5_data$Condition == "AB"] and h5_data$Accuracy[h5_data$Condition == "AB"]
## S = 3544528365, p-value < 2.2e-16
## alternative hypothesis: true rho is not equal to 0
## sample estimates:
##      rho
## 0.2664223

nb_rho <- nb_corr$estimate
ab_rho <- ab_corr$estimate
```

Interpretation: The Spearman correlation (ρ) represents the monotonic relationship between confidence and accuracy. A higher ρ in the NB condition (0.268) compared to the AB condition (0.266) suggests stronger metacognitive alignment in the natural boundary group.

3.8.4 22.2 Mann-Whitney U Test (Confidence)

Before assessing the relationship, we check if there is a general difference in confidence levels between conditions.

```
# Compare confidence scores between groups
h5_mw_conf <- wilcox.test(Confidence ~ Condition, data = h5_data)

cat("--- Mann-Whitney U Test: Confidence by Condition ---\n")
```

```
## --- Mann-Whitney U Test: Confidence by Condition ---
```

```
print(h5_mw_conf)

##
## Wilcoxon rank sum test with continuity correction
##
## data: Confidence by Condition
## W = 5569915, p-value = 2.049e-06
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
```

Interpretation: This test evaluates whether one group is generally more confident than the other. A p-value of 0 indicates a statistically significant difference in raw confidence levels between NB and AB participants.

3.8.5 22.3 Interaction Regression

We use a logistic-style regression (simplified for transparency) to test if the impact of Confidence on Accuracy depends on the Condition.

```
# Accuracy ~ Confidence * Condition interaction
# Note: Using a linear model on probabilities as a robust approximation
m_h5_reg <- lm(Accuracy ~ Confidence * Condition, data = h5_data)
anova_h5_reg <- as.data.frame(anova(m_h5_reg))

cat("--- Regression ANOVA: Confidence x Condition Interaction ---\n")
```

```
## --- Regression ANOVA: Confidence x Condition Interaction ---
```

```
print(anova_h5_reg)
```

	Df	Sum Sq	Mean Sq	F value	Pr(>F)
## Confidence	1	6.268423e+01	62.684233814	566.99070112	3.246290e-120
## Condition	1	7.613609e-01	0.761360891	6.88665266	8.704535e-03
## Confidence:Condition	1	4.729897e-03	0.004729897	0.04278281	8.361413e-01
## Residuals	6483	7.167347e+02	0.110556017	NA	NA

```
h5_int_p <- anova_h5_reg["Confidence:Condition", "Pr(>F)"]
```

Interpretation: The interaction term (Confidence:Condition) tests if the slope of the confidence-accuracy relationship significantly differs between groups. A p-value of 0.83614 does not support the hypothesis that alignment is moderated by blocking condition.

3.8.6 22.4 Permutation Correlation Test

A resampling approach to test if the difference between the two correlation coefficients ($\rho_{NB} - \rho_{AB}$) is significant.

```
set.seed(42)
obs_diff <- nb_rho - ab_rho

# Permute Condition labels 10,000 times
perm_diffs <- replicate(10000, {
  shuffled_cond <- sample(h5_data$Condition)
  cor(h5_data$Confidence[shuffled_cond == "NB"], h5_data$Accuracy[shuffled_cond == "NB"], method = "spearmanr") -
  cor(h5_data$Confidence[shuffled_cond == "AB"], h5_data$Accuracy[shuffled_cond == "AB"], method = "spearmanr")
})

h5_perm_p <- mean(abs(perm_diffs) >= abs(obs_diff))
cat("--- Permutation Test Results ---\n")
```

```
## --- Permutation Test Results ---
```

```
cat(sprintf("Observed Correlation Difference: %.4f\n", obs_diff))
```

```
## Observed Correlation Difference: 0.0013
```

```
cat(sprintf("Permutation p-value: %.5f\n", h5_perm_p))
```

```
## Permutation p-value: 0.96100
```

Interpretation: After 10,000 permutations, the resulting p-value of 0.961 demonstrates whether the observed difference in correlation strength is greater than what would be expected by chance.

3.8.7 Expected Result

We expect that the Natural Blocking (NB) condition will show a significantly stronger correlation between confidence and accuracy than the Abrupt Blocking (AB) condition. This would indicate that participants in the NB condition have more accurate metacognitive insights into their own memory performance.

3.8.8 22.5 Summary of Findings (H5)

```
h5_summary_tbl <- tibble(
  Test = c("Spearman Correlation (NB)", "Spearman Correlation (AB)", "Confidence Comparison (MWU)", "In
  Result = c(round(nb_rho, 3), round(ab_rho, 3), sprintf("p = %.4f", h5_mw_conf$p.value), sprintf("p = %
  Significant = c(
    ifelse(nb_corr$p.value < 0.0125, "Yes", "No"),
    ifelse(ab_corr$p.value < 0.0125, "Yes", "No"),
    ifelse(h5_mw_conf$p.value < 0.0125, "Yes", "No"),
    ifelse(h5_int_p < 0.0125, "Yes", "No"),
    ifelse(h5_perm_p < 0.0125, "Yes", "No")
  )
)

kable(h5_summary_tbl, digits = 4, caption = "Summary of Confidence-Accuracy Relationship Tests")
```

Table 5: Summary of Confidence-Accuracy Relationship Tests

Test	Result	Significant
Spearman Correlation (NB)	0.268	Yes
Spearman Correlation (AB)	0.266	Yes
Confidence Comparison (MWU)	p = 0.0000	Yes
Interaction (Confidence x Condition)	p = 0.8361	No
Permutation Test (Diff in Cor)	p = 0.9610	No

- **Support:** The hypothesis that **Metacognitive alignment is stronger in NB than AB** is **not supported** by the current data ($p = 0.598$).

3.9 23. H6 — Difficulty Moderation

3.9.1 Hypothesis

The Boundary Advantage (BB – EM) is stronger for difficult trials than for easy trials.

3.9.2 Methodology

This section investigates whether the saliency of event boundaries provides a greater memory benefit when the stimulus itself is more difficult to recognize. We define **Difficulty** based on the global average accuracy per stimulus across all participants.

We apply a **Bonferroni correction** ($\alpha = 0.0125$) across four tests: - Kruskal-Wallis (on difference scores across Difficulty levels) - ART ANOVA (FrameType x Difficulty interaction) - Pairwise Mann-Whitney U tests - Permutation test on difficulty trends

```
# 1. Calculate difficulty per movie_id based on mean accuracy
stimulus_difficulty_map <- desc_trial %>%
  group_by(movie_id_num) %>%
  summarise(mean_acc = mean(Accuracy, na.rm = TRUE), .groups = "drop") %>%
  mutate(Difficulty = factor(ifelse(mean_acc < median(mean_acc), "Hard", "Easy")))

# 2. Join back to trial-level data
h6_trial_data <- desc_trial %>%
  inner_join(stimulus_difficulty_map %>% select(movie_id_num, Difficulty), by = "movie_id_num")

# 3. Create participant-level difference scores per difficulty level
h6_diff_data <- h6_trial_data %>%
  group_by(participant_id, FrameType, Difficulty) %>%
  summarise(mean_acc = mean(Accuracy, na.rm = TRUE), .groups = "drop") %>%
  pivot_wider(names_from = FrameType, values_from = mean_acc) %>%
  mutate(diff_score = BB - EM) %>%
  filter(!is.na(diff_score))

cat("Total observations for Difficulty analysis:", nrow(h6_diff_data), "\n")

## Total observations for Difficulty analysis: 330
```

3.9.3 23.1 Kruskal–Wallis Test

The Kruskal-Wallis test evaluates whether the Boundary Advantage (`diff_score`) differs significantly between “Easy” and “Hard” trial groups.

```
# Kruskal-Wallis on difference scores
h6_kw_result <- kruskal.test(diff_score ~ Difficulty, data = h6_diff_data)

cat("--- Kruskal-Wallis Test: Boundary Advantage by Difficulty ---\n")

## --- Kruskal-Wallis Test: Boundary Advantage by Difficulty ---

print(h6_kw_result)
```

```
##
## Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test
##
## data: diff_score by Difficulty
## Kruskal-Wallis chi-squared = 0.0069286, df = 1, p-value = 0.9337
```

Interpretation: This test checks for an overall effect of Difficulty on the magnitude of the Boundary Advantage. A p-value of 0.93366 indicates whether difficulty significantly moderates the effect.

3.9.4 23.2 ART ANOVA (Extended Interaction)

We test for the interaction between FrameType and Difficulty Level.

```
# Aligned Rank Transform ANOVA for Interaction
m_h6_art <- art(Accuracy ~ FrameType * Difficulty + (1|participant_id), data = h6_trial_data)
anova_h6_art <- as.data.frame(anova(m_h6_art))

cat("--- ART ANOVA Results: FrameType x Difficulty Interaction ---\n")
```

```
## --- ART ANOVA Results: FrameType x Difficulty Interaction ---
```

```
print(anova_h6_art)
```

```
##                               Term          F Df  Df.res      Pr(>F)
## FrameType                     FrameType 1347.09011  1 6321.008 1.615818e-267
## Difficulty                     Difficulty 4332.94266  1 6322.028 0.000000e+00
## FrameType:Difficulty FrameType:Difficulty   38.59445  1 6322.501 5.548547e-10
```

```
h6_int_p <- anova_h6_art["FrameType:Difficulty", "Pr(>F)"]
```

Interpretation: The interaction term (FrameType:Difficulty) is the critical test for H6. A p-value of 0 demonstrates whether the difference between BB and EM frames significantly increases as trial difficulty increases.

3.9.5 23.3 Pairwise Mann–Whitney U Test

We compare the difference scores for Easy and Hard trials directly.

```
# Pairwise comparison
h6_mw_result <- wilcox.test(diff_score ~ Difficulty, data = h6_diff_data)

cat("--- Mann-Whitney U: Hard vs Easy Advantage Scores ---\n")
```

```
## --- Mann-Whitney U: Hard vs Easy Advantage Scores ---
```

```
print(h6_mw_result)
```

```
##
## Wilcoxon rank sum test with continuity correction
##
## data: diff_score by Difficulty
## W = 13541, p-value = 0.9341
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
```

```
# Median Advantage by Difficulty
h6_med_summary <- h6_diff_data %>%
  group_by(Difficulty) %>%
  summarise(Median_Advantage = median(diff_score), .groups = "drop")
print(h6_med_summary)
```



```
## # A tibble: 2 x 2
##   Difficulty Median_Advantage
##   <fct>           <dbl>
## 1 Easy             0
## 2 Hard          -0.0101
```

Interpretation: Comparing the median advantage for Hard trials (-0.01) vs Easy trials (0) allows us to see the direction of the moderation.

3.9.6 23.4 Permutation Test

A resampling approach (10,000 resamples) to test if the observed difference in Boundary Advantage across difficulty levels is stable.

```
# Permutation test on difficulty labels
h6_perm_test <- oneway_test(diff_score ~ factor(Difficulty), data = h6_diff_data,
                           distribution = approximate(nresample = 10000))

cat("--- Permutation Test Results ---\n")
```

```
## --- Permutation Test Results ---
```

```
print(h6_perm_test)
```

```
##
## Approximative Two-Sample Fisher-Pitman Permutation Test
##
## data: diff_score by factor(Difficulty) (Easy, Hard)
## Z = 0.009168, p-value = 0.9928
## alternative hypothesis: true mu is not equal to 0
```

```
h6_perm_p <- as.numeric(coin::pvalue(h6_perm_test))
```

Interpretation: The permutation-based p-value of 0.9928 validates the significance of the difficulty effect without parametric assumptions.

3.9.7 Expected Result

We expect the Boundary Advantage (BB - EM) to be significantly larger in Hard trials than in Easy trials, suggesting that event boundaries provide the most critical mnemonic support when cognitive load or trial complexity is high.

3.9.8 23.5 Summary of Findings (H6)

```
h6_summary_tbl <- tibble(
  Test = c("Kruskal-Wallis", "ART ANOVA Interaction", "Mann-Whitney (Hard vs Easy)", "Permutation Test"),
  Result = c(sprintf("p = %.4f", h6_kw_result$p.value), sprintf("p = %.4f", h6_int_p), sprintf("p = %.4f", h6_mw_result$p.value), sprintf("p = %.4f", h6_perm_p)),
  Significant = ifelse(c(h6_kw_result$p.value, h6_int_p, h6_mw_result$p.value, h6_perm_p) < 0.0125, "Yes", "No")
)

kable(h6_summary_tbl, digits = 4, caption = "Summary of Difficulty Moderation Tests")
```

Table 6: Summary of Difficulty Moderation Tests

Test	Result	Significant
Kruskal-Wallis	p = 0.9337	No
ART ANOVA Interaction	p = 0.0000	Yes
Mann-Whitney (Hard vs Easy)	p = 0.9341	No
Permutation Test	p = 0.9928	No

3.9.9 Conclusion (H6)

The results **do not support** the hypothesis that the Boundary Advantage is stronger for difficult trials ($p = 0.934$). This suggests that event boundaries do not provide prioritized mnemonic support specifically for harder stimuli in this sample.

3.10 24. H7 — Variability Effect

3.10.1 Hypothesis

The Abrupt Blocking (AB) condition shows higher performance variability (variance) than the Natural Blocking (NB) condition.

3.10.2 Methodology

This section examines whether interrupting natural event structures leads to more inconsistent memory performance. We test the equality of variance between the two experimental conditions.

We apply a **Bonferroni correction** ($\alpha = 0.0125$) across four tests: - Levene's Test (Equality of variance) - Brown-Forsythe Test (Robust variance test using medians) - Standard Deviation (SD) comparison with permutation - Bootstrapped Variance comparison (98.75% Confidence Interval)

```
# Use participant-level mean accuracy
h7_data <- participant_level_desc %>%
  filter(!is.na(mean_accuracy)) %>%
  select(participant_id, Condition, mean_accuracy)

cat("Total participants included in variability analysis:", nrow(h7_data), "\n")
```

```
## Total participants included in variability analysis: 165
```

3.10.3 24.1 Levene's Test

Levene's test evaluates the null hypothesis that the population variances are equal.

```
# Levene's test for equality of variance
h7_levene_result <- car::leveneTest(mean_accuracy ~ Condition, data = h7_data)

cat("--- Levene's Test: Accuracy Variance by Condition ---\n")
```

```
## --- Levene's Test: Accuracy Variance by Condition ---
```

```
print(h7_levene_result)
```

```
## Levene's Test for Homogeneity of Variance (center = median)
##      Df F value Pr(>F)
## group 1  0.7093 0.4009
##      163
```

```
h7_levene_p <- h7_levene_result[["Pr(>F)"]][1]
```

Interpretation: A significant p-value (0.4009) would indicate that the variances of the two conditions are significantly different, supporting the hypothesis of unequal variability.

3.10.4 24.2 Brown–Forsythe Test

The Brown–Forsythe test is a robust version of Levene’s test that uses the median instead of the mean, making it less sensitive to outliers.

```
# Brown-Forsythe test
h7_bf_result <- car::leveneTest(mean_accuracy ~ Condition, data = h7_data, center = median)

cat("--- Brown-Forsythe Test: Robust Variance Comparison ---\n")
```

```
## --- Brown-Forsythe Test: Robust Variance Comparison ---
```

```
print(h7_bf_result)
```

```
## Levene's Test for Homogeneity of Variance (center = median)
##      Df F value Pr(>F)
## group 1  0.7093 0.4009
##      163
```

```
h7_bf_p <- h7_bf_result[["Pr(>F)"]][1]
```

Interpretation: The Brown–Forsythe test provides a more conservative estimate of variance differences. Using the adjusted alpha of 0.0125, we check if the result is non-significant.

3.10.5 24.3 SD Comparison + Permutation

We compare the observed standard deviations and use a permutation test (10,000 resamples) to assess significance.

```
set.seed(42)
sd_nb <- sd(h7_data$mean_accuracy[h7_data$Condition == "NB"])
sd_ab <- sd(h7_data$mean_accuracy[h7_data$Condition == "AB"])
obs_sd_diff <- sd_ab - sd_nb

# Permute condition labels
perm_sd_diffs <- replicate(10000, {
  shuffled_cond <- sample(h7_data$Condition)
```

```
sd(h7_data$mean_accuracy[shuffled_cond == "AB"]) - sd(h7_data$mean_accuracy[shuffled_cond == "NB"])
})
```

```
h7_perm_p <- mean(perm_sd_diffs >= obs_sd_diff)
```

```
cat(sprintf("Observed SD (NB): %.4f\n", sd_nb))
```

```
## Observed SD (NB): 0.0717
```

```
cat(sprintf("Observed SD (AB): %.4f\n", sd_ab))
```

```
## Observed SD (AB): 0.0823
```

```
cat(sprintf("Permutation p-value (SD_AB > SD_NB): %.5f\n", h7_perm_p))
```

```
## Permutation p-value (SD_AB > SD_NB): 0.17060
```

Interpretation: By shuffling group labels, we determine if the higher variability in the AB group is a stable feature of the data or a chance occurrence.

3.10.6 24.4 Bootstrapped Variance Comparison

We compute the 98.75% Confidence Interval for the difference in variances ($\sigma_{AB}^2 - \sigma_{NB}^2$).

```
# Bootstrap the difference in variance
boot_var_diffs <- replicate(10000, {
  var(sample(h7_data$mean_accuracy[h7_data$Condition == "AB"], replace = TRUE)) -
  var(sample(h7_data$mean_accuracy[h7_data$Condition == "NB"], replace = TRUE))
})
```

```
h7_ci_lower <- quantile(boot_var_diffs, 0.00625)
```

```
h7_ci_upper <- quantile(boot_var_diffs, 0.99375)
```

```
cat("--- Bootstrap Variance Results (98.75% CI) ---\n")
```

```
## --- Bootstrap Variance Results (98.75% CI) ---
```

```
cat(sprintf("Observed Variance Difference: %.4f\n", var(h7_data$mean_accuracy[h7_data$Condition == "AB"] -
```

```
## Observed Variance Difference: 0.0016
```

```
cat(sprintf("CI: [%.4f, %.4f]\n", h7_ci_lower, h7_ci_upper))
```

```
## CI: [-0.0023, 0.0060]
```

Interpretation: If the confidence interval includes 0, it suggests no significant difference in the spread of accuracy between conditions.

3.10.7 Expected Result

We expect the Abrupt Blocking (AB) condition to exhibit higher variance in memory performance compared to the Natural Blocking (NB) condition, reflecting the disruptive nature of breaking temporal context.

3.10.8 24.5 Summary of Findings (H7)

```
h7_summary_tbl <- tibble(  
  Test = c("Levene's Test", "Brown-Forsythe", "Permutation (SD Difference)", "Bootstrap (CI > 0)"),  
  Result = c(sprintf("p = %.4f", h7_levene_p), sprintf("p = %.4f", h7_bf_p), sprintf("p = %.4f", h7_perm_p),  
  Significant = c(  
    ifelse(h7_levene_p < 0.0125, "Yes", "No"),  
    ifelse(h7_bf_p < 0.0125, "Yes", "No"),  
    ifelse(h7_perm_p < 0.0125, "Yes", "No"),  
    ifelse(h7_ci_lower > 0, "Yes", "No")  
  )  
)  
  
kable(h7_summary_tbl, digits = 4, caption = "Summary of Variability Hypothesis Tests")
```

Table 7: Summary of Variability Hypothesis Tests

Test	Result	Significant
Levene's Test	p = 0.4009	No
Brown-Forsythe	p = 0.4009	No
Permutation (SD Difference)	p = 0.1706	No
Bootstrap (CI > 0)	No	No

3.10.9 Conclusion (H7)

All variance tests consistently indicate that the AB condition **does not have significantly different variability** compared to the NB condition ($p = 0.400$ at $\alpha = 0.0125$).

3.11 25. H8 — Encoding Strength Effect

3.11.1 Hypothesis

Better encoding (operationalized as longer study time/encoding duration) leads to a stronger Boundary Advantage (BB – EM).

3.11.2 Methodology

This section tests whether the depth or duration of the encoding phase influences the saliency of event boundaries in retrieval. We use the calculated `encoding_minutes` for each participant as our measure of encoding strength.

We apply a **Bonferroni correction** ($\alpha = 0.0125$) across four tests: - Spearman Correlation (Encoding duration vs. Boundary Advantage) - Linear Regression (`diff_score ~ encoding_minutes`) - Median Split comparison (High vs. Low encoding time) - Permutation test on encoding influence

```

# 1. Calculate Boundary Advantage per participant
h8_diff_data <- participant_frametype_desc %>%
  select(participant_id, FrameType, mean_accuracy) %>%
  pivot_wider(names_from = FrameType, values_from = mean_accuracy) %>%
  mutate(diff_score = BB - EM)

# 2. Join with encoding duration from encoding_tbl
h8_data <- h8_diff_data %>%
  inner_join(encoding_tbl %>% select(participant_id, encoding_minutes), by = "participant_id") %>%
  filter(!is.na(diff_score), !is.na(encoding_minutes))

cat("Total participants included in Encoding analysis:", nrow(h8_data), "\n")

```

```
## Total participants included in Encoding analysis: 165
```

3.11.3 25.1 Spearman Correlation

We test the monotonic relationship between how long a participant studied and their resulting Boundary Advantage.

```

# Spearman correlation
h8_spearman_result <- cor.test(h8_data$encoding_minutes, h8_data$diff_score, method = "spearman")

cat("--- Spearman Correlation: Encoding Duration vs. Boundary Advantage ---\n")

```

```
## --- Spearman Correlation: Encoding Duration vs. Boundary Advantage ---
```

```
print(h8_spearman_result)
```

```

##
## Spearman's rank correlation rho
##
## data: h8_data$encoding_minutes and h8_data$diff_score
## S = 768367, p-value = 0.7372
## alternative hypothesis: true rho is not equal to 0
## sample estimates:
## rho
## -0.02632277

```

```
h8_rho <- h8_spearman_result$estimate
```

Interpretation: The Spearman's rho ($\rho = -0.026$) indicates the strength and direction of the link between study time and boundary prioritized memory. A p-value of 0.73717 tells us if this relationship is significant.

3.11.4 25.2 Linear Regression

We use a linear model to see if encoding time serves as a significant predictor of the Boundary Advantage magnitude.

```
# diff_score ~ encoding_minutes
m_h8_reg <- lm(diff_score ~ encoding_minutes, data = h8_data)
sum_h8_reg <- summary(m_h8_reg)

cat("--- Regression Summary: Predicting Boundary Advantage ---\n")
```

```
## --- Regression Summary: Predicting Boundary Advantage ---
```

```
print(sum_h8_reg)
```

```
##
## Call:
## lm(formula = diff_score ~ encoding_minutes, data = h8_data)
##
## Residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -0.32288 -0.06934  0.02081  0.07637  0.24128
##
## Coefficients:
##              Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)    0.212939   0.595623   0.358   0.721
## encoding_minutes -0.009467   0.023219  -0.408   0.684
##
## Residual standard error: 0.106 on 163 degrees of freedom
## Multiple R-squared:  0.001019,    Adjusted R-squared:  -0.00511
## F-statistic: 0.1662 on 1 and 163 DF,  p-value: 0.684
```

```
h8_reg_p <- coef(sum_h8_reg)[2, "Pr(>|t|)"]
```

Interpretation: The regression analysis determines if every additional minute of encoding significantly increases the difference between BB and EM frame accuracy. At an alpha of 0.0125, the effect is not significant.

3.11.5 25.3 Median Split + Mann–Whitney Test

We categorize participants into “Deep Encoders” and “Quick Encoders” based on a median split of study duration.

```
# Median split on encoding time
h8_data_split <- h8_data %>%
  mutate(Encoding_Group = ifelse(encoding_minutes > median(encoding_minutes), "Longer", "Shorter"))

h8_mw_result <- wilcox.test(diff_score ~ Encoding_Group, data = h8_data_split)

cat("--- Mann-Whitney U: Boundary Advantage by Encoding Group ---\n")
```

```
## --- Mann-Whitney U: Boundary Advantage by Encoding Group ---
```

```
print(h8_mw_result)
```

```
##  
## Wilcoxon rank sum test with continuity correction  
##  
## data: diff_score by Encoding_Group  
## W = 3244.5, p-value = 0.6057  
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
```

```
h8_med_summary <- h8_data_split %>%  
  group_by(Encoding_Group) %>%  
  summarise(Median_Advantage = median(diff_score), .groups = "drop")  
print(h8_med_summary)
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 x 2  
##   Encoding_Group Median_Advantage  
##   <chr>          <dbl>  
## 1 Longer          -0.0164  
## 2 Shorter         -0.00526
```

Interpretation: This test evaluates whether participants who spent more time encoding (Median Advantage = -0.016) showed a larger frame-type effect than those who studied less.

3.11.6 25.4 Permutation Test

A resampling approach to test the significance of encoding strength without assuming linear normality.

```
# Permutation test on diff_score ~ encoding_minutes  
set.seed(42)  
obs_corr <- cor(h8_data$encoding_minutes, h8_data$diff_score, method = "pearson")  
  
perm_corrs <- replicate(10000, {  
  cor(sample(h8_data$encoding_minutes), h8_data$diff_score, method = "pearson")  
})  
  
h8_perm_p <- mean(abs(perm_corrs) >= abs(obs_corr))  
  
cat(sprintf("Observed Pearson Correlation: %.4f\n", obs_corr))
```

```
## Observed Pearson Correlation: -0.0319
```

```
cat(sprintf("Permutation p-value: %.5f\n", h8_perm_p))
```

```
## Permutation p-value: 0.69210
```

Interpretation: The permutation-based p-value of 0.6921 validates the predictive power of encoding strength on the boundary advantage.

3.11.7 Expected Result

We expect that participants who spent more time studying the video (Better Encoding) will exhibit a significantly stronger Boundary Advantage. This would imply that boundary prioritization in memory increases as the overall strength of the memory trace is enhanced.

3.11.8 25.5 Summary of Findings (H8)

```
h8_summary_tbl <- tibble(  
  Test = c("Spearman Correlation", "Linear Regression", "Median Split (MWU)", "Permutation Test"),  
  Result = c(sprintf("rho = %.3f", h8_rho), sprintf("p = %.4f", h8_reg_p), sprintf("p = %.4f", h8_mw_re),  
  Significant = ifelse(c(h8_spearman_result$p.value, h8_reg_p, h8_mw_result$p.value, h8_perm_p) < 0.012  
)  
  
kable(h8_summary_tbl, digits = 4, caption = "Summary of Encoding Strength Hypotheses")
```

Table 8: Summary of Encoding Strength Hypotheses

Test	Result	Significant
Spearman Correlation	rho = -0.026	No
Linear Regression	p = 0.6840	No
Median Split (MWU)	p = 0.6057	No
Permutation Test	p = 0.6921	No

3.11.9 Conclusion (H8)

The statistical evidence **does not support** the hypothesis that better encoding leads to a stronger boundary advantage ($\rho = -0.026$, $p = 0.758$).

3.12 26. Final Results Summary

This table provides a high-level overview of all eight research hypotheses investigated in this report. The “Status” column indicates whether the hypothesis was supported (TRUE) or not supported (FALSE) based on the primary statistical tests and their respective significance thresholds (adjusted for multiple comparisons where applicable).

```
final_summary <- tibble(  
  ID = paste0("H", 1:8),  
  Hypothesis = c(  
    "Condition Effect: NB participants show higher accuracy than AB participants",  
    "Boundary Advantage: BB frames show higher accuracy than EM frames",  
    "EM Stability: EM accuracy is stable across conditions (NB vs AB)",  
    "Interaction Effect: Boundary advantage (BB - EM) is stronger in NB than AB",  
    "Confidence-Accuracy: Metacognitive alignment is stronger in NB than AB",  
    "Difficulty Moderation: Boundary advantage is stronger for difficult trials",  
    "Variability Effect: AB condition shows higher performance variability",  
    "Encoding Strength: Study duration predicts overall boundary advantage"  
  ),  
  `Primary Result` = c(  

```

```

sprintf("p = %.4f", mw_result$p.value),
sprintf("p = %.4f", h2_art_p),
sprintf("p = %.4f", h3_art_p),
sprintf("p = %.4f", h4_art_interaction_p),
sprintf("p = %.4f", h5_perm_p),
sprintf("p = %.4f", h6_int_p),
sprintf("p = %.4f", h7_levene_p),
sprintf("p = %.4f", h8_reg_p)
),
Status = c(
  mw_result$p.value < 0.05,          # H1 uses alpha 0.05
  FALSE,                            # H2 fails due to direction reversal (EM > BB)
  h3_art_p >= 0.0125,                # H3 Stability is supported by non-significance
  h4_art_interaction_p < 0.0125,     # H4 Interaction alpha 0.0125
  h5_perm_p < 0.0125,               # H5 alpha 0.0125
  h6_int_p < 0.0125,                # H6 alpha 0.0125
  h7_levene_p < 0.0125,             # H7 alpha 0.0125
  h8_reg_p < 0.0125                 # H8 alpha 0.0125
)
)

kable(final_summary, caption = "Summary of All Research Hypotheses and Results Status")

```

Table 9: Summary of All Research Hypotheses and Results Status

ID	Hypothesis	Primary Result	Status
H1	Condition Effect: NB participants show higher accuracy than AB participants	p = 0.0042	TRUE
H2	Boundary Advantage: BB frames show higher accuracy than EM frames	p = 0.0018	FALSE
H3	EM Stability: EM accuracy is stable across conditions (NB vs AB)	p = 0.0146	TRUE
H4	Interaction Effect: Boundary advantage (BB - EM) is stronger in NB than AB	p = 0.7113	FALSE
H5	Confidence-Accuracy: Metacognitive alignment is stronger in NB than AB	p = 0.9610	FALSE
H6	Difficulty Moderation: Boundary advantage is stronger for difficult trials	p = 0.0000	TRUE
H7	Variability Effect: AB condition shows higher performance variability	p = 0.4009	FALSE
H8	Encoding Strength: Study duration predicts overall boundary advantage	p = 0.6840	FALSE

End of Behavioral Data Analysis Suite